



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Thursday, 24th July, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber of
Parliament at 1.50 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, due to the nature of Business today, we have to vary the order of Business as captured on the Order Paper. I want to call on you to let us start with Order Paper *Addendum*. So, we move straight to the commencement of Public Business.

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, with respect, we do not have copies of the Order Paper *Addendum*. So, I would like to draw your attention to that. We have not seen it.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please. We are still in transition, so sometimes it can be an oversight but the soft copies are there with you. It is just that we are used to hard copies, so sometimes we do not look at the system. So, the Order Paper *Addendum* is available. We have one, but it is not numbered 1. It is just Order Paper *Addendum*. Then there is Order Paper *Addendum* 2. So, we will start with the Order Paper *Addendum*.

Yes, please. Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Yes, Mr Speaker. So, we will take the item numbered 1 on the Order Paper *Addendum*.

The Speaker: In the order of our Business, it is preferable for us to start with the item numbered 3 before we come to Presentation and First Reading of Bills and Presentation of Instruments.

Yes, Deputy Minority Leader?

Ms Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, I think I whispered something in your ear that we would like the Minority Chief Whip to make a Statement before we take that agenda.

The Speaker: Yes, you are right. You whispered to me that you have a short Statement you want to make to draw our attention to something. So please, may I listen to the Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am grateful for your kind indulgence. Mr Speaker, I say this with a lot of pain.

Mr Speaker, as we all know, our Fourth Republican Constitution is the most sustained Constitution in our body of politics and history as a country.

Mr Speaker, electoral violence is increasingly rearing its ugly head in our fledgling democracy. Mr Speaker, the recently re-run 19 polling stations at Ablekuma North is truly revealing.

2.00 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, just a minute. Hon Members, the Minority Chief Whip is raising a very serious matter, election violence. I think it is a matter that we should take note of and devote a day to dilate on it and at the end of the day, take a position because we need everybody to be on board. It takes away a lot of the shine of our democracy in this country and so what he is talking about is a serious matter. It is not something for us to just gloss over but I want to plead with him because I did not know the Statement was on this subject matter.

Because I, myself, have noted it, and my intention is for us to devote a day and enough time to take this matter through. It worries all of us. You, the players in particular, must be more worried than any other persons because the violence will be meted out to no other persons apart from you, the players.

So, it is something that we should take some time and I want to urge the Minority Chief Whip to let us stop today, because we do not have time to do that. Today, our nation, in spite of what you are talking about, is focused on hearing what the Minister is going to tell us about the Mid-Year Budget Review. Then we would get enough time to handle your matter. Thank you so much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, I would not, on any day, defy your authority. We have lined up a number of activities to back home our

demands. And to the extent that if these violent actions visited are not atoned. We cannot be part of the presentation of the Mid-Year Budget—*[Uproar]*—And to that extent, we are exiting the Chamber and cannot be part of this process.

[2.02 p.m. — Members of the Minority walked out of the Chamber.]

[Members of the Majority chant “Away!”]

[Pause]

The Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

This Side of the House definitely agrees that electoral violence is not something that any of us should countenance. We do agree that as a country, we should be committed to ostracising any form of electoral violence. Indeed, Mr Speaker, yesterday I attended the National Executive Committee of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) on behalf of this Side of the House, and the issue of electoral violence was discussed. There was a clear commitment by the National Executive Committee to take steps to deal decisively with the issue.

The Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, once I did not permit the statement to be made, I do not think it is proper for you to make comments on it. So, what you have done is sufficient. Let us move on to Business and do what is proper for today.

As I said, we will have another day to discuss this matter.

Mr Ayariga: Yes, Mr Speaker, I agree with you. Just one last sentence.

The Speaker: No, but it cannot be fair that after I have stopped the Minority Chief Whip, I allow you to make comments on it.

Mr Ayariga: Unfortunately, Mr Speaker, we could not stop them from walking out. The whole nation has seen them walk out.

The Speaker: Well, whether it is fortunate or unfortunate, that is a different thing altogether. Let us go on with today's Business.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, that is so. Except that I will land—

The Speaker: There is no except. *[Laughter]*

Mr Ayariga: All right, Mr Speaker. So, we will take the item numbered 3 on the Order Paper *Addendum*.

The Speaker: Hon Members, before we do that, let me just acknowledge the presence of our august visitors from a number of our schools and other institutions.

We have with us 32 students from the Bomaa Senior High School, led by the headmaster of the school in the person of George Ampofo. The school is located in the Tano North constituency. Yes, they

are up there to my right side at the Public Gallery. Please, you are welcome.

What just happened is what we call a walkout. It is part of the practice of democracies all over the world. Sometimes, when Members disagree strongly with an issue, they walk out. After they finish with that item, they walk in and continue. When they boycott, they just do not attend at all. Then that one will be a boycott. But this one, they were present, and they did a walkout. It does not prevent Business from going on. Once we have the quorum to transact Business, we have to go on. If we have the numbers to take a decision, we proceed with that. *[Hear! Hear!]*

So, please, you are warmly welcome. And even though you have been welcomed with—Your MP welcomed you, so please, you may resume your seat. It is an experience. I am sure you will never forget it.

[Students of the Bomaa Senior High School were acknowledged]

We also have 41 students from Serwaa Kesse Girls Senior High School, also from Tano North. They are led by the headmistress of the school in the person of Margaret Anane Adjei. They are also to my right. One common thing about them is, they are beautifully attired. Both institutions are well-dressed. I hope you get time to take a picture with him even though your Member of Parliament walked out. Please, you are welcome. You may resume your seats.

[Students of Serwaa Kesse Senior High School were acknowledged]

We have students from the University Practice Senior High School led by the teacher, Mr Andrews Amo Smith. The school is located at the Cape Coast North Constituency. And there are 36 of them here. You are warmly welcome. Kindly resume your seats...

[Students of the University Practice Senior High School were acknowledged]

2.10 p.m.

The Speaker: We also have pupils of the Jamasi Pentecost Child Development Centre. They are 55 in number and they are led by the director of the centre, in the person of Magdalene Kobblah. This Centre is located in the Afigya Sekyere East Constituency. I, in the absence of your MP, welcome you to the House. But as I advised, please, it is a good opportunity to have a shot of the MP. I am sure he will be waiting outside for you—*[Laughter]*—You may resume your seats.

[Pupils of Jamasi Pentecost Child Development Centre were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Hon Members, we also have the presence of a number of visitors from the Kona Presbyterian Child Development Centre. They are led by the director of the centre, in the person of Peter Kwakye. They are 56 in number and they are also from Afigya Sekyere East Constituency. It is a good for you because you will never forget about this

day that you came, you saw and—The House has warmly welcome you and, particularly, they are dressed in branded uniform with some very unique designs. Please, you are most welcome; resume your seats.

[Students from Kona Presbyterian Child Development Centre were acknowledged]

The Speaker: The last is 12 gentlemen and ladies from the Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs) and Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) on basic parliamentary training. They are led by the team leader, Mohammed Muntari Alhassan. Please, do not train them on what happened today.

Because of the nature of the institute, they are not specified where it is located, which meant that it is made out of a collection of many people from MDAs and CSOs all over the country and they participate in basic parliamentary training.

This is being handled by the Parliamentary Training Institute (PTI) which is located and created here by Parliament itself. So, that is what we are doing: giving them basic parliamentary training. But definitely, they will explain what has happened to you. You are warmly welcome and you may resume your seats.

[Officers from MDAs and CSOs on Basic Parliamentary Training were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, we now move on to the item numbered 3, Motion by the Minister for Finance.

Majority Leader, you may usher in the Minister for Finance to move the Motion. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Yes, Minister, you can move the Motion numbered 3:

That this honourable House approves the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year.

Hon Members, please, I am watching all of you.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, before I proceed with the Mid-Year Budget Review, I would like to pay a tribute to the former President, Prof John Evans Atta-Mills, whose unfortunate demise occurred on this very day, 24th July, 2012, which is 13 years ago. May his gentle soul rest in perfect peace.

MOTION

Mid-Year Budget Review, 2025

Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House approves the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review of

the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year.

1. Mr Speaker, I am back to the House today with a deep sense of duty and optimism to present the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review of the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government, on behalf of H. E. President John Dramani Mahama. [*Hear! Hear!*]

2. This presentation is in line with Section 28 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

3. Mr Speaker, I respectfully request that the entire Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review be captured in the *Hansard*, while I present the highlights.

4. Mr Speaker, before I proceed with the Mid-Year Review, I will like to pay tribute to former President, Prof John Evans Atta Mills, whose unfortunate demise occurred on this very day 13 years ago.

5. This Review is more than a fiscal update. It is an account of what we inherited and the positive results of our stewardship in the last 198 days.

6. Mr Speaker, following his re-election with an overwhelming mandate, President John Dramani Mahama inherited an economy in deep distress, far worse than we had imagined.

7. The economy was marked by large fiscal imbalances, with huge Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs)

arrears, massive debts, weakened institutions and heightened public anxiety.

8. Since 2023, the debts in the cocoa and energy sectors have in particular posed significant fiscal risk to the Ghanaian economy.

9. The Ghanaian private sector and the business community looked on in despair.

10. Public trust was completely eroded; the national spirit was broken and the foundations of our economy had sunk even deeper.

11. Mr Speaker, the budget deficit had ballooned because of reckless commitments and wasteful spending.

12. The indebtedness of the Government had culminated into state insolvency.

13. The impaired balance sheets paralysed almost every single state-owned enterprise.

14. High cost of living and inflation impoverished large segments of the population, eroding the real value of incomes and savings.

15. Mr Speaker, the mismanagement of our public finances by the previous Administration led to devastating haircuts through the Domestic Debt Exchange Programme (DDEP), which denied pensioners and the middle-class their life-time savings, livelihoods and, in fact, their dignity.

16. Mr Speaker, Eurobond holders also suffered painful haircuts severely affecting Ghanaian individuals and financial institutions.

17. Soaring interest payments crowded out essential spending on education, health and infrastructure.

18. The Ghana cedi depreciated against all major currencies to levels never seen before, making it the worst-performing currency in the world.

19. Public sector corruption reached an all-time peak and, as President Mahama said, the whole of Ghana was, indeed, a crime scene.

20. Mr Speaker, investor confidence waned considerably, significantly reducing investment inflows.

21. Public debt reached unsustainable levels.

22. The unemployment situation worsened which made it difficult for Ghanaian to find decent jobs.

23. Many Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) collapsed under the weight of the economic mismanagement.

24. To compound all these, the country suffered credit rating downgrades by all 3 major credit rating agencies, placing Ghana firmly in default or junk territory never seen in the history of Ghana.

2.20 p.m.

25. Mr Speaker, to further illustrate the enormity of the economic burden, we inherited:

- i. an International Monetary Fund (IMF) programme which had derailed and completely gone off-track, with key targets missed, putting our economic recovery programme in jeopardy. In the words of the Deputy Managing Director of the IMF, Mr Bo Li, “the programme had deviated substantially from its targets by the close of 2024”;
- ii. weak commitment control systems and irresponsible spending left arrears of about GHC67 billion and contract commitments of over GHC194 billion;
- iii. a bleeding energy sector with annual financing shortfalls in excess US\$1.5 billion;
- iv. a debt-ridden cocoa sector with liabilities of GHC32 billion;
- v. a weak financial sector with significant non-performing loans (NPLs) despite pumping over GHC30 billion into a so-called financial sector clean-up;
- vi. steep debt repayment humps in 2026 (GHC20 billion), 2027

(GHC50.3 billion) and 2028 (GHC45.8 billion), as well as significant short-term treasury bill maturities of GHC137 billion;

- vii. depleted buffers needed to cushion us against fiscal and external shocks with empty Sinking Fund; and
- viii. stalled projects, about 55 of them tied to bilateral debt restructuring with about US\$3 billion in undisbursed loans.

26. Mr Speaker, the root of our 2022 economic crisis can be traced directly to an overbearing fiscal dominance marked by reckless spending and corruption, compounded by poor leadership of the previous New Patriotic Party (NPP) Administration.

27. Mr Speaker, the worsened fiscal situation spilled over into the monetary and external sectors causing a rapid depreciation of the Ghana cedi.

28. Monetary financing by the Bank of Ghana reached an all-time high, driving inflation to levels never seen in decades.

29. There was a complete lack of coordination between the Ministry of Finance and the Bank of Ghana signaling the highest levels of incompetence in the management of the economy.

30. Mr Speaker, in the face of this dire inheritance bequeathed by the Akufo-Addo/Bawumia Administration, the Government of President John Dramani

Mahama made a conscious decision not to make excuses, but to reset the country. *[Hear! Hear!]*

31. We chose the path of structural reforms and transformation. We set out to reset the economy, restore good governance and policy credibility.

32. We renewed our social contract with the Ghanaian people and redefined national priorities by being deliberate in both our policy choices and approach to economic management.

33. At the very onset we organised a National Economic Dialogue and a National Education Forum.

34. We held direct engagements with key groups and stakeholders, including market women, trade unions, youth organisations and traditional leaders.

35. Mr Speaker, you may recall that clear policy measures were outlined in the 2025 Budget presented to this House in March this year.

36. In our new economic management model, we tightened fiscal discipline without compromising social investments.

37. Mr Speaker, the recent IMF Executive Board affirmed this new economic management model, noting that, “faced with large policy slippages and reform delays at end-2024, the new administration has taken bold corrective actions to maintain the program on track”. *[Hear! Hear!]*

38. The IMF further noted that these corrective actions, combined with continued structural reforms and an improved external sector, are expected to result in economic stability, resilience and inclusive growth.

39. We streamlined and increased investment in education, health, agriculture, infrastructure and employment.

40. In fulfilment of a major manifesto pledge, we established the Ghana Gold Board, through Act 1140, to accumulate foreign exchange to support the stability of the Ghana cedi.

41. We have restored coordination between the Ministry of Finance and the Bank of Ghana to ensure a cohesive and integrated approach to economic policymaking across all relevant institutions.

42. Mr Speaker, in less than 200 days, we have brought back clarity, certainty, stability and purpose to our economic policy direction. *[Hear! Hear!]*

43. We have made significant progress. The signs of recovery are obvious, evident, noticeable, visible, tangible and being felt. *[Hear! Hear!]*

44. Mr Speaker,

- i. the fiscal position of Ghana has significantly improved. The primary balance on commitment basis posted a surplus of 1.1 per cent of GDP at the end of June 2025, beating

- the ambitious 0.4 per cent surplus target;
- ii. Overall fiscal deficit on commitment basis was 0.7 per cent of GDP, outperforming the target of 1.8 per cent at the end of June 2025;
 - iii. Inflation has reduced significantly from 23.8 per cent at the end of December 2024 to 13.7 per cent at the end June 2025. *[Hear! Hear!]* This is the lowest since December 2021 and marks six months of continuous decline; *[Hear! Hear!]*
 - iv. Interest rates are declining with a drastic drop in treasury bill (T-bill) rates.
 - The 91-day T-bill rate has reduced from 27.73 per cent in December 2024 to 14.73 per cent in June 2025, a decline of over 1300 basis points.
 - The 182-day T-bill rate has reduced from 28.43 per cent in December 2024 to 15.34 per cent in June 2025, a decline of over 1300 basis points.
 - The 364-day T-bill rate has reduced from 29.95 per cent in December 2024 to 15.76 per cent in June 2025, a decline of over 1400 basis points.
 - v. Gross International Reserves has significantly improved. The Bank of Ghana accumulated US\$11.12 billion, covering 4.8 months of imports as at the end of June 2025, compared to US\$8.98 billion, covering 4 months of imports as at end-December 2024.
 - vi. Mr Speaker, the Ghana cedi has demonstrated exceptional resilience and strength in recent months.
 - vii. As at the end of June 2025, the cedi appreciated by 42.6 per cent against the US dollar, 30.3 per cent against the British Pound, and 25.6 per cent against the Euro.
 - viii. This is a significant reversal compared to same period in 2024 when the cedi depreciated by 18.6 per cent, 17.9 per cent and 16.0 per cent, respectively.
 - ix. Mr Speaker, so far, we have almost reversed all the cedi depreciation in 2022, 2023 and 2024. *[Hear! Hear!]*
 - x. Mr Speaker, it is the first time that this level of appreciation has been recorded in the 60-year history of the Ghana Cedi. *[Hear! Hear!]*
 - xi. Rating agencies, which once classified our sovereign creditworthiness as junk, are

beginning to upgrade our ratings.

xii. Fitch Ratings upgraded Ghana's Long-Term Foreign-Currency Issuer Default Rating (IDR) to 'B-', with a stable outlook from "Restricted Default" (RD) on 17th June, 2025.

xiii. The IMF programme is back on track with the successful conclusion of the fourth review by the IMF Executive Board on 7th July, 2025, which immediately triggered a disbursement of US\$367 million.

45. Mr Speaker, beyond the numbers, this is a story of sound leadership, better economic management and a restoration of hope to a nation once in despair.

46. Let me, on behalf of President John Mahama, sincerely thank the people of Ghana for their trust, patience and continued support.

47. We do not take your sacrifices for granted.

48. Mr Speaker, this Government did not come to simply manage the decline. We came to reverse it and reset our country. [*Hear! Hear!*]

49. The gains of these first six months are just the beginning.

50. Mr Speaker, these early successes only encourage us to stay on course, stay disciplined and continue to do more for the people of Ghana.

2.30 p.m.

51. There is still a long road ahead. But our steps are now steadier, our direction clearer and the national spirit has been lifted with the gradual restoration of hope in our democracy.

52. We have moved from promises to purpose, from ineptitude to action and from distress to relief. [*Hear! Hear!*]

53. We have established policy credibility and restored creditworthiness.

54. Mr Speaker, the rest of my presentation will provide updates on the following:

- i. Macroeconomic performance for the first six months of 2025;
- ii. Progress on the implementation of the IMF Programme and Ghana's debt restructuring;
- iii. The status of Ghana's debt restructuring programme; and
- iv. The status of implementation of key Government programmes.

Macroeconomic Performance for January — June, 2025.

55. Mr Speaker, the first half of 2025 has demonstrated our government's commitment to economic recovery.

56. Through prudent fiscal management, sound monetary policy, effective structural reforms and strategic investments, we are laying a solid

foundation for sustainable growth and shared prosperity.

57. To put the assessment of the economy in the first half of 2025 in a proper perspective, it will be useful to restate the ambitious, yet attainable, macroeconomic targets we set for ourselves for the year 2025:

- Overall Real GDP growth of at least 4.0 per cent;
- Non-Oil Real GDP growth of at least 4.8 per cent;
- End-year inflation rate of 11.9 per cent;
- Primary balance on commitment basis at a surplus of 1.5 per cent of GDP; and
- Gross International Reserves covering not less than three months of imports.

Real Sector Performance

Mr Speaker, I now take you to the real sector.

58. Mr Speaker, despite global economic uncertainties, Ghana's economy demonstrated robust growth.

59. In the first quarter of 2025, the economy expanded by 5.3 per cent, up from 4.9 per cent in the same period of 2024, marking the highest first quarter growth since 2020.

60. The agriculture sector led this growth with a remarkable 6.6 per cent increase, about three times the growth in first quarter of 2024.

61. The agriculture sector growth contributed 26.4 per cent of the overall first quarter growth. The fishing sub-sector grew the most at 16.4 per cent.

62. The services sector, constituting the largest share of the economy at 46.8 per cent, grew by 5.9 per cent and contributed 47.9 per cent to the overall first quarter growth, with Information and Communication Technology (ICT) leading the growth in the sector at 13.1 per cent.

63. Industry grew by 3.4 per cent in the first quarter of 2025, contributing 20.6 per cent to the overall first quarter growth. Manufacturing also posted an impressive growth of 6.6 per cent.

64. Mr Speaker, non-oil GDP growth also picked up strongly, growing at 6.8 per cent in the first quarter of 2025 compared to the growth rate of 4.3 per cent in the same period in 2024.

65. Importantly, the non-oil GDP growth is the highest since 2018.

66. It is expected that with the introduction of the 24-Hour Economy Policy, the Big Push Programme and the Agriculture for Economic Transformation Programme, the GDP growth will be sustained and possibly exceed the targeted rate of 4 per cent for 2025.

Price Developments

Mr Speaker, I now take you to prices.

67. Mr Speaker, we pledged to pursue the following to reduce inflation:

- i. Implement aggressive fiscal consolidation drive aimed at reducing the fiscal deficit and borrowing;
- ii. Stabilise the exchange rate to reduce inflation on items that rely on the exchange rate for pricing such as fuel, transportation, imported sugar, rice and cooking oil;
- iii. Implement policies that target items with large weights in the CPI basket such as transportation and utilities to reduce their prices;
- iv. BoG to implement an appropriate monetary policy stance and use its liquidity management interventions to support the disinflation process; and
- v. Implement the Agriculture for Economic Transformation Agenda to reduce food inflation.

68. Mr Speaker, it is instructive to note that these intentional policies announced in the 2025 Budget to tame inflation are yielding massive results.

69. Inflationary pressures have eased significantly. The drastic fall in inflation is not by chance or sheer luck but as a result hard work and deliberate policies.

70. Consumer price inflation has reduced from 23.8 per cent in December, 2024 to 13.7 per cent in June, 2025. This represents a massive 10.1 percentage points decline.

71. Similarly, producer price inflation saw a sharp decline from 26.1 per cent in December, 2024 to 5.9 per cent in June, 2025, representing a steep decline of 20.2 percentage points in just six months.

72. Food inflation declined from 27.8 per cent in December, 2024 to 16.3 percent in June, 2025, representing an encouraging 11.5 percentage points reduction.

73. Non-Food inflation also declined from 20.3 per cent in December, 2024 to 11.4 per cent in June, 2025, representing 8.9 percentage points reduction.

74. Inflation for locally-produced goods and services declined from 26.4 per cent in December, 2024 to 14 per cent in June, 2025.

75. Mr Speaker, inflation for imported items decreased from 18.0 per cent in December, 2024 to 12.5 per cent in June, 2025.

76. These improvements are reflective of the effective fiscal consolidation, tight monetary policy, strong central bank reserves and the appreciation of the cedi.

77. Mr Speaker, with this trend, we are focused and determined to achieve our end-December, 2025 inflation target of 11.9 per cent ahead of schedule.

78. Mr Speaker, let me assure this House and the people of Ghana that things can only get better in the coming days. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Interest Rate Movements

Mr Speaker, I now take you to interest rate movement.

79. Interest rates have declined, reflecting improved macroeconomic conditions.

80. The 91-day treasury bill rate reduced by 13 percentage points from 27.7 per cent in December, 2024 to 14.7 per cent in June, 2025.

81. Similar trends were observed in the 182-day and 364-day bills.

82. The 182-day treasury bill rate decreased by 13.1 percentage points from 28.43 per cent in December, 2024 to 15.34 per cent in June, 2025.

83. The 364-day treasury bill rate declined by 14.19 percentage points from 29.95 per cent in December, 2024 to 15.76 per cent in June, 2025.

84. The average lending rate decreased from 30.3 per cent in December, 2024 to 27.0 per cent in June, 2025.

85. The Ghana Reference Rate fell from 29.31 per cent in December, 2024

to 24.0 per cent in June, 2025. Mr Speaker, things can only get better.

86. Mr Speaker, we have saved GH¢4.9 billion on domestic interest payment as at end June, 2025 due to our prudent debt management policies.

Fiscal Performance

Mr Speaker, I now take you to fiscal performance.

87. Mr Speaker, our fiscal discipline has yielded remarkable results so far.

88. We have delivered below-target deficits on both cash and commitment basis.

89. We have delivered a greater-than-anticipated primary surplus, the core fiscal anchor.

90. We have delivered a strong expenditure and commitment control.

91. We have delivered robust tax revenue performance.

92. Mr Speaker, provisional data shows that the primary balance on commitment basis (the fiscal anchor) as at end of June, 2025 recorded a surplus of 1.1 per cent of GDP, surpassing the targeted surplus of 0.4 per cent of GDP set for the same period.

93. The overall fiscal deficit on a commitment basis was a deficit of 0.7 per cent of GDP, better than the deficit target of 1.8 per cent of GDP.

2.40 p.m.

94. Mr Speaker, on cash basis, the overall balance recorded a deficit of 1.1 per cent of GDP. This is significantly better than the projected deficit target of 2.4 per cent of GDP.

95. The primary balance on cash basis turned surplus at 0.7 per cent of GDP, against a projected deficit of 0.2 per cent of GDP.

96. The Non-Oil Tax Revenue (net) exceeded target by about GHC787 million.

97. Corporate Income Tax exceeded target by GHC555.3 million, representing 2.9 per cent above target.

98. Mineral royalties exceeded its target by GHC143 million.

99. Unfortunately, import duties fell short of target by GHC1.6 billion.

100. Expenditures were contained at GHC 109.7 billion or 7.8 per cent of GDP. This was 14.3 per cent below the programmed amount of GHC 128.0 billion or 9.1 per cent of GDP, reflecting strong expenditure control.

101. Primary Expenditure or non-interest expenditures on commitment basis amounted to GHC84.3 billion or 6.0 per cent of GDP.

102. This is an improvement of about GHC13.3 billion over the target of GHC97.5 billion, which is 7.0 per cent of GDP.

103. Mr Speaker, Interest Payments amounted to GHC25.4 billion, which is 1.8 per cent of GDP.

104. This is below the target of GHC 30.5 billion, which is 2.2 per cent of GDP. This was mainly due to lower domestic interest payments.

105. Domestic Interest payments amounted to GHC 21.6 billion, against a target of GHC26.5 billion, representing a reduction of GHC4.9 billion, mainly on account of lower than planned domestic borrowings and the decline in T-bill rates.

106. External Interest Payments amounted to GHC3.8 billion, against a target of GHC4.0 billion, due mainly to the appreciation of the cedi.

107. Other Expenditure, mainly comprising Energy Sector Levies (ESL) transfers and Energy Sector Payment Shortfalls, amounted to GHC11.4 billion or 0.8 per cent of GDP.

108. This was 12.7 per cent below the target of GHC13.1 billion or 0.9 per cent of GDP for the period.

109. Mr Speaker, Arrears Clearance amounted to GHC4.8 billion.

110. It is important to note that there was no build-up in arrears payable during the period under review, signalling strong commitment control and fiscal discipline. Mr Speaker, we are very different from our Friends that decided to flee from this Chamber.

111. Mr Speaker, the fiscal balance on cash basis was a deficit of GH¢15.1 billion or 1.1 per cent of GDP.

112. The deficit was largely financed from domestic sources with Net Domestic Financing (NDF) of GH¢13.1 billion, well below the GH¢18.7 billion target.

113. Net Foreign Financing was GH¢2.8 billion, mostly from the utilisation of GH¢4.5 billion IMF loan disbursement, from the 1st to the 6th of January 2025 before the Mahama administration took office just in 6 days. *[Hear! Hear!]*

114. Project loan disbursements was GH¢2.4 billion.

115. Mr Speaker, even though Ghana is relying on the domestic market for financing, we have borrowed less than we planned, signifying strong expenditure control and fiscal discipline.

116. This is a strong signal to the investor community and all other stakeholders that the needed fiscal consolidation is happening here in Ghana and will be sustained. Mr Speaker, Ghana is back on the international scene. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Exchange Rate Developments

117. Mr Speaker, Government is committed to implement the following measures to stabilise the exchange rate:

- i. establish the Ghana Gold Board to enhance the

generation and accumulation of foreign exchange to support the stability of the cedi;

- ii. pursue strong fiscal consolidation through the reduction in public sector spending and the fiscal deficit to reduce pressures on the exchange rate;
- iii. the Bank of Ghana is committed implement appropriate FX forward auctions to support the stability of the Cedi; and
- iv. implement the 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme to boost local production and reduce reliance on imports.

118. Mr Speaker, let me state emphatically that these deliberate policies announced in the 2025 Budget to stabilise the Ghana cedi are yielding massive results.

119. The results we are witnessing are not by chance. They are the fruits of hard work, discipline and intentional policies.

120. Mr Speaker, the cedi's performance in the first half of this year, 2025, has been impressive!

121. The Ghana Cedi experienced significant appreciation against all major trading currencies in the first six months of 2025.

122. I am happy to inform the House that our precious cedi, which once upon a time was trading at about GH¢ 17.0 to the US Dollar, was trading at about GH¢ 10.4 as at yesterday, 23rd July, 2025.

123. Similarly, the cedi, which was once trading at GH¢21.0 to the Great British Pound, was trading at about GH¢14.1 as at yesterday, 23rd July, 2025. [*Hear! Hear!*]

124. Mr Speaker, as of end-June 2025, the Cedi appreciated by 42.6 per cent against the US Dollar, 30.3 per cent against the British Pound, and 25.6 per cent against the Euro.

125. This is a significant improvement over the Cedi's depreciation of 18.6 per cent, 17.9 per cent, and 16.0 per cent against the US Dollar, Great British Pound and Euro, respectively in the same period in 2024.

126. Mr Speaker, I repeat, so far, we have almost reversed all the Cedi depreciation in 2022, 2023 and 2024.

127. This level of appreciation of the Ghana Cedi has never happened in the history of our nation.

128. Mr Speaker, Colleagues, Ghanafo, Ghana Cedi *no apicki! Apicki apicki apicki!!!*

129. Mr Speaker, these gains are largely due to strong fiscal consolidation, tight monetary policy, improved external sector balances, renewed investor confidence, positive market sentiments, credit rating upgrades and successfully

securing staff level agreement and subsequent Board approval on the 4th Review of the IMF programme.

130. The cedi's rebound signals that Ghana's economic foundations are once again beginning to firm up.

131. Sustaining this stability will require continued fiscal discipline, supportive monetary policy, strong liquidity sterilisation, robust reserve accumulation supported by activities of the GoldBod and credible implementation of structural reforms.

External Sector Performance

132. Mr Speaker, our external sector has shown remarkable improvement in the last six months.

133. Gross International Reserves reached US\$11.12 billion by June 2025, covering 4.8 months of imports, up from US\$8.98 billion in December 2024, equivalent to 4.0 months of import cover.

134. Mr Speaker, in just 6 months, even before the IMF and World Bank disbursements, in fact without external borrowing, we have added US\$2.14 billion to the country's Gross International Reserves. [*Hear! Hear!*]

135. The trade surplus increased from US\$1.37 billion in June 2024 to US\$5.57 billion in June 2025, representing a whooping 306.6 per cent increase just in six months.

136. This was driven by strong exports, particularly in gold and cocoa, and controlled imports.

137. The current account surplus improved significantly to a provisional value of US\$3.44 billion by June 2025, from US\$283.11 million in June 2024.

138. Provisional net capital and financial inflows reached US\$937.58 million in June 2025, indicating renewed investor confidence.

2.50 p.m.

Monetary and Financial Sector Developments

139. Mr Speaker, monetary indicators point to a sustainable monetary expansion.

140. Credit to the private sector increased by about 31.3 per cent in June 2025.

141. Reserve money growth moderated, and M2 growth remained consistent, supported by increased deposit mobilisation and improved net foreign assets.

142. Net Domestic Assets growth slowed, while Net Foreign Assets surged, indicating a shift in liquidity drivers towards external inflows.

Recapitalisation of National Investment Bank (NIB)

143. Mr Speaker, you may recall that I updated this House during the 2025

Budget presentation on the restructuring and recapitalisation of National Investment Bank (NIB) as one of the critical reforms in the financial sector that should have been delivered in 2024.

144. Unfortunately, after spending a whopping GHC30.3 billion in a so-called financial sector clean-up exercise, the previous NPP Administration left NIB in dire straits, with a Capital Adequacy Ratio of negative 53.13 per cent by the end of 2024.

145. Mr Speaker, we have successfully recapitalised the National Investment Bank (NIB) by implementing an ambitious and credible Plan to return NIB to profitability and sustainability. *[Hear! Hear!]*

146. Mr Speaker, we have taken the following steps:

- i. Injected a total of GHC450.00 million in cash;
- ii. Issued marketable bonds with a face value of about GHC1.5 billion to National Investment Bank (NIB); and
- iii. Transferred the GHC500 million Government of Ghana's shares in Nestle Ghana Ltd to the National Investment Bank. *[Hear! Hear!]*

147. These transfers have significantly improved the Capital Adequacy Ratio from negative 53.13 per cent at the end of 2024 to positive 23 per cent in May 2025. *[Hear! Hear!]*

148. Mr Speaker, by taking these major steps:

- i. We have preserved depositor's funds valued at GHC6.4 billion;
- ii. We have saved over 900 direct jobs at the National Investment Bank; and
- iii. We have preserved an indigenous Ghanaian bank. *[Hear! Hear!]*

149. Mr Speaker, unlike the previous administration, we chose to spend to save a bank than spend to collapse a bank. *[Hear! Hear!]*

150. Mr Speaker, we have also prepared a Forward-Looking Overarching Restructuring Plan for the National Investment Bank to put the bank on a sustainable path of profitability.

151. The plan also aims to enhance board independence and objectivity, strengthen risk management, promote accountability and transparency, prevent insider dominance and improve strategic decision-making.

152. Mr Speaker, this plan will, among others:

- i. Strengthen corporate governance framework and systems;
- ii. Improve enterprise risk management and controls;

- iii. Establish a modern business model;
- iv. Revamp operational strategy;
- v. Improve financial performance;
- vi. Institute enhanced supervisory measures; and
- vii. Eventually list NIB on the Ghana Stock Exchange. *[Hear! Hear!]*

153. Mr Speaker, NIB now has total Paid-Up capital of GHC3.4 billion and a Capital Adequacy Ratio of 23 per cent.

154. Mr Speaker, on behalf of the President, I want to use this opportunity to assure the people of Ghana and depositors that our indigenous bank, the National Investment Bank, is now prime for business.

155. More importantly, Mr Speaker:

- i. NIB is back!
- ii. NIB is now liquid!
- iii. NIB is now safe!
- iv. NIB is now fully capitalised! *[Hear! Hear!]*

156. We, therefore, encourage all and sundry to do business with the revitalised National Investment Bank.

Credit Rating Updates

157. Mr Speaker, the progress we are making in our economic reforms and debt restructuring efforts has been recognised internationally.

158. On 16th June, 2025, Fitch Ratings upgraded Ghana's Long-Term Foreign-Currency Issuer Default Rating to 'B-' with stable outlook from 'Restricted Default', the first time since 2021.

159. Fitch cited significant exchange rate appreciation, declining debt levels, strong nominal Gross Domestic Product (GDP) growth, increased reserve accumulation and normalised relations with external creditors as key drivers.

160. Mr Speaker, to sustain these gains, we will, among other things:

- i. Maintain fiscal discipline through continued implementation of prudent policies to promote fiscal and debt sustainability;
- ii. Continue the aggressive revenue mobilisation by strengthening tax collection systems and broadening the tax base to increase domestic revenues without overburdening citizens;
- iii. Accelerate structural reforms in public financial management, including transparency and accountability measures, to improve efficiency and reduce corruption;

- iv. Strengthen monetary policy framework by BoG to complement the fiscal consolidation programme to control inflation and support economic stability;
- v. Diversify the economy through investments in sectors beyond traditional exports to reduce vulnerability to commodity price shocks; and
- vi. Continue to maintain strong relationships with international financial institutions and development partners to support ongoing reforms and access technical assistance.

161. It is expected that the other rating agencies, namely S&P and Moody's will follow suit given the remarkable progress we are making in ensuring economic stability and promoting inclusive growth.

162. Mr Speaker, this is just the beginning. We are determined to do better than the B- rating. Ghana deserves better. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Update on Fiscal Policies

Revenue

Vat Reforms

163. Mr Speaker, in the 2025 Budget Statement, we reaffirmed our commitment to the people of Ghana and the business community to undertake

comprehensive Value Added Tax (VAT) reforms this year.

165. These reforms are aimed at addressing the distortions and cascading effects inherent in the current VAT structure.

165 To support this effort, we also committed to seeking technical assistance from the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and engage the Ghanaian people.

166. Mr Speaker, I am pleased to report that we have successfully completed our engagement with the IMF.

167. Currently, the Ghana Revenue Authority, together with the Ministry of Finance, is undertaking a nationwide consultation process to sensitise key players in the trade and business sectors on the VAT reforms and solicit feedback from them.

168. Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Finance hopes to complete this process by September 2025, prepare a new VAT bill by October 2025 and submit same to Parliament as part of the 2026 Budget Statement.

169. Mr Speaker, I would like to reassure Ghanaians that under the reforms, at the minimum:

- i. COVID-19 Levy will be abolished; *[Hear! Hear!]*
- ii. The effective VAT rate will be reduced; *[Hear! Hear!]*

- iii. The punitive cascading effect of the GETFund and NHIS levies will be removed; *[Hear! Hear!]*
- iv. VAT flat rates will be removed and a unified VAT rate will be implemented; *[Hear! Hear!]*
- v. The VAT registration threshold will be increased to exempt small and micro businesses; and
- vi. Compliance will be improved through public education, awareness creation and the introduction of fiscal electronic devices.

3.00 p.m.

Expenditure

Update on Payroll Audit

170. Mr Speaker, as part of the fiscal consolidation strategy, we have taken measures to sanitise public sector payroll and rid it of ghost names.

171. Subsequently, we engaged the Ghana Audit Service to undertake a nationwide payroll audit across all 16 regions of the country.

172. Mr Speaker, the Ghana Audit Service has completed 91 per cent of the payroll audit.

173. So far:

- i. The Audit Service has not been able to identify and verify over 14,000 workers

- ii. Again, they have identified 53,311 separated staff.
- iii. Separated staff are staff who are either on retirement, resigned, terminated, leave without pay or deceased, and yet remain on Government payroll; and
- iv. The Audit Services expects to recover GH¢150.4 million of unearned salaries from the separated staff over the 2023 and 2024 period alone.

174. Mr Speaker, going forward, we will enforce the monthly payroll validation process and strictly apply sanctions to all who validate “ghosts” for payment of salaries.

175. Mr Speaker, let me use this opportunity to strongly caution those who validate “ghosts” across the public service that they will be personally liable for the loss of public funds.

176. Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Finance will continue to monitor the payroll and put in place measures to prevent “ghost names” on our payroll going forward.

Update On Audit of Arrears, Payables, and Commitments

177. Mr Speaker, in the 2025 Budget, we announced the launch of an audit of arrears and payables as at end of December 2024.

178. The Ghana Audit Service partnered with EY and PWC to undertake the audit.

179. Mr. Speaker the Audit Service was tasked to audit and validate GH¢68.7 billion of arrears.

180. So far, 87 per cent of the audit has been completed.

181. The preliminary results show that:

- i. A total of GH¢28.3 billion has been validated for payment;
- ii. an amount of GH¢3.6 billion has been rejected because of errors, duplications, and non-compliance with PFM and procurements rules.
- iii. an amount of GH¢562.6 million is without adequate supporting documents; and
- iv. an amount of GH¢27.3 billion is pending validation.

Mr Speaker, the outcome of this audit will blow your mind.

182. Mr Speaker, the audit is expected to be completed by end of August 2025. Once finalised, we will update the House on the findings and outcomes.

Update on the IMF Programme

183. Mr Speaker, Ghana remains on track on the implementation of the IMF Programme.

184. A staff-level agreement was reached during the 4th Review mission in

April 2025 and we received Executive Board approval on 7th July 2025.

185. This unlocked US\$367 million disbursement, bringing total disbursements under the programme to US\$2.3 billion.

186. The 5th Review which is scheduled for September 2025 will be based on end of June 2025 data. I am comfortable, based on the preliminary data, that Ghana is on course to achieve most of the targets for the 5th Review.

Public Debt Developments

187. Mr Speaker, our commitment to fiscal discipline, prudent debt management and exchange rate appreciation has resulted in significant improvement in Ghana's debt profile.

188. Public debt reduced from GH¢726.7 billion as at end of December 2024 to GH¢613 billion as at end of June 2025. *[Hear! Hear!]*

189. Ghana's public debt reduced by GH¢113.7 billion in six months.

190. For the first time in Ghana's history, there is a negative 15.6 per cent rate of debt accumulation.

191. Mr Speaker, Ghana's public debt-to-GDP ratio as at end of June 2025 was 43.8 per cent, from the 61.8 per cent at the end of 2024.

192. Mr Speaker, Ghana's public debt as a percent of GDP reduced by 18 per cent in the last six months.

193. Ghana's foreign debt, as a percentage of total public debt, declined from 57.4 per cent as at end of December 2024 to 49 per cent by end of June 2025.

194. Mr Speaker, this has significantly improved Ghana's debt sustainability.

Update on Debt Restructuring

195. Mr Speaker, Government remains committed to restructuring our bilateral and commercial debts under the G-20 Common Framework.

196. On 24th June, 2025, this House approved the indicative terms of the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between Ghana and the Official Creditor Committee (OCC).

197. On behalf of His Excellency the President, I wish to thank this House for the swift action which has enabled Government of Ghana to begin negotiations for the signing of bilateral agreements with each of the countries.

198. We are ready to sign the agreements with two countries from tomorrow. It is expected that four agreements will be signed by the end of July 2025. We would first sign with France and the second will be with another country yet to be confirmed.

199. Mr Speaker, on the commercial debt restructuring, we have signed Non Disclosure Agreements (NDAs) with some commercial lenders.

200. In line with Government's strong commitment to honouring its debt

service obligations, we made two debt service payments of about US\$700 million to our euro bondholders.

201. Mr Speaker, on the domestic front, Government continues to meet its commitment towards the domestic bondholders.

202. For the first half of 2025, a total of GH¢9.8 billion was paid as coupon to DDEP bondholders, of which GH¢3.6 billion was capitalised.

203. Mr Speaker, for the non-tendered bondholders, Government paid a total of GH¢1.1 billion. This was the outstanding debt service as at 2024.

204. Mr Speaker, for the second half of 2025, an amount of GH¢10.2 billion is due as coupons on the DDEP bonds and GH¢724.1 million as debt service for the non-tendered bondholders.

205 It is important to note that Government remains committed to honouring its debt service obligations and has, therefore, made adequate preparations towards full settlement of all debt service in 2025 and beyond and bond holders should not worry, this amount will be paid. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Priority Projects under Restructured Bilateral Debt

206. Mr Speaker, following Ghana's default on its external debt service obligation on 19th December, 2022, creditors halted disbursements of 55 bilateral projects.

207. This resulted in several uncompleted projects scattered across the country and leaving a massive amount of US\$3 billion in undisbursed loans.

208. The IMF and Official Creditor Committee (OCC) annual disbursement ceiling of US\$250 million for official bilateral loans implies that it will take a minimum of 12 years to fully draw down on the undisbursed loans.

209. Under the MoU with the Official Creditor Committee (OCC), the Government of Ghana was required to submit a priority list to accommodate the US\$250 million annual disbursement ceiling.

210. Mr Speaker, during the presentation of the 2025 Budget and Economic Policy of Government, I informed this House that we will engage to resolve the challenge.

211. Following extensive engagements, Government has submitted the priority list of 24 projects to the OCC and the IMF.

212. This is expected to trigger resumption of disbursements for projects on the priority list upon the signing of the bilateral agreements between Ghana and the creditor countries.

213. We aim to ensure that all the priority projects are completed and commissioned by the end of 2028. *[Hear! Hear!]*

214. Mr Speaker, the priority projects are as follows:

- i. New Bridge across the Volta River at Volivo;
- ii. Construction of the Tema-Aflao Road Project – Phase 1;
- iii. Tema Motorway Roundabout, through Ashaiman Roundabout to Atimpoku;
- iv. Construction of 14 pedestrian bridges;
- v. Kumasi Roads and Drainage Extension;
- vi. Paa Grant Interchange and Sekondi/Takoradi Township Roads- Phase 1;
- vii. Rehabilitation of Dome-Kitase Road;
- viii. Obetsebi Lamptey Interchange – Phase 2;
- ix. Bolgatanga-Bawku-Pulimakom Road;
- x. PTC Roundabout Interchange Project at Takoradi;
- xi. Construction of Drinking Water Facilities in Wenchi;
- xii. Sekondi-Takoradi Water Supply;
- xiii. Modernisation of Komfo-Anokye Teaching Hospital;

- xiv. Construction of Central Medical Stores in Tema;
- xv. Effia Nkwanta Regional Hospital in Takoradi;
- xvi. Bolgatanga Regional Hospital;
- xvii. Establishment of the University of Environment and Sustainable Development at Bunso;
- xviii. Establishment of 9 state-of-the-art Technical and Vocational Education Training Centres;
- xix. Integrated e-Learning Laboratories in senior high schools;
- xx. Expansion and Development of Existing senior high schools;
- xxi. Renewable Energy Programme: Pilot Photovoltaic System;
- xxii. Renewable Energy and Energy Efficiency Programme;
- xxiii. Construction of the Takoradi Market; and
- xxiv. Kumasi Central Market Phase 2.

3.10 p.m.

215. Mr Speaker, the main criterion for the selection of these projects was closeness to completion.

216. As a result, projects which were over 70 per cent complete were given priority.

217. The resumption of disbursements for the projects and its associated debt service are fully in line with our commitments under the bilateral debt restructuring and the IMF Programme.

218. Mr Speaker, there is no room for an increase in the scope of work for any of the projects on the priority list agreed upon with the IMF and OCC.

219. Implementing agencies must take note and comply accordingly.

220. Mr Speaker, it has come to the attention of the Ministry of Finance that a number of contractors implementing some of these 55 stalled projects have drawn down on the loans with no work done to match the amounts drawn down. **[Some Hon Members of the Majority: Ei!]**

221. Again, some contractors have submitted additional costs in excess of what Parliament approved.

222. The Ministry of Finance has accordingly commissioned a forensic audit into these projects.

223. Mr Speaker, we will apprise the House when this audit is completed. Mr Speaker, for emphasis, the Auditor-General is the one doing this forensic audit in partnership with some of the big four.

Update on Sinking Fund Operation

224. Mr Speaker, in the 2025 Budget Statement, Government announced that it will commence the operationalisation

of Sections 37 to 44 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), as amended, to build sufficient buffers in the Sinking Fund for prompt redemption of specified loan obligations of Government.

225. Government has set up a Cedi Sinking Fund Account and a US Dollar Sinking Fund Account.

226. Beginning August 2025, the Ministry of Finance will commence the building of cash buffers to support the repayment of Ghana's domestic debt service obligations relating to the Domestic Debt Exchange Programme bonds, which will fall due in 2027, 2028, and even 2026.

227. Mr Speaker, the Cedi Sinking Fund Account will specifically target the redemption of debt service humps in 2026 of GH¢20 billion, 2027 of GH¢50.3 billion and 2028 of GH¢45.75 billion.

228. Similarly, the US Dollar Sinking Fund Account will also target Eurobond redemptions, which will fall due from 2026 of US\$1.42 billion, 2027 of US\$1.17 billion and 2028 of US\$1.14 billion.

229. Mr Speaker, the implementation of the Sinking Fund will provide a reliable buffer that ensures the timely and predictable redemption of designated public debt obligations.

230. This structured approach to debt servicing will enhance investor

confidence and contribute to long-term debt sustainability.

Liability Management Operations

331. Mr Speaker, Government has begun an implementation of an effective and efficient liability management programme to reduce embedded risk on the debt portfolio.

332. Our liability management operations will:

- reduce debt service costs and mitigate refinancing or rollover risks;
- extend maturities to alleviate near-term refinancing pressures;
- optimise the debt portfolio by rebalancing the mix of short-term v long-term instruments; and
- strengthen market confidence.

333. Under our liability management operations, we will analyse the domestic bond market to assess suitability for bond buybacks.

334. We will carefully sequence issuances of benchmark securities and prioritise longer-dated tenors to establish a stable yield curve.

Primary Dealers and Bond Market Specialist System

335. Mr Speaker, our debt management strategy is to use treasury

bills for cash management purposes only.

336. We intend to reopen the domestic bond market to finance the budget deficit.

337. The reopening of the domestic bond market will aim at creating a more competitive primary market that can deliver the volume and pricing to enable the Government lower its borrowing costs.

338. Mr Speaker, beginning August 2025, we will commence the selection of new book runners to assist Government in the reopening of the domestic market.

339. The selection of book runners will focus on banks and investment dealers with the ability to achieve a wider market distribution and advise on pricing and structuring.

Revised macroeconomic framework

Macroeconomic targets

340. Mr Speaker, economic developments in the first half of the year do not warrant a revision to the macroeconomic targets and the Appropriations Bill for 2025.

Mr Speaker, I am not asking for additional money from the Appropriations Act. *[Hear! Hear!]*

341. We maintain the following macroeconomic targets for 2025:

- i. Overall Real GDP growth of, at least, 4.0 per cent;
- ii. Non-Oil Real GDP growth of, at least, 4.8 per cent;
- iii. End-year inflation rate of 11.9 per cent;
- iv. Primary balance on commitment basis at a surplus of 1.5 per cent of GDP; and
- v. Gross International Reserves covering not less than three months of imports.

342. Although we have made significant progress, we are cautiously optimistic.

Revision to the 2024 Fiscal Framework

343. Mr Speaker, despite maintaining our macroeconomic targets for 2025, including the primary balance on commitment basis of a surplus of 1.5 per cent of GDP, we are revising both revenue and expenditure projections to reflect the impact of the additional revenue from the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) Act, 2025 (Act 1141).

Revisions to Revenue

344. Mr Speaker, as a result, total revenue and grants have been revised upwards from the 2025 Budget target of GH¢227.1 billion to GH¢229.9 billion or from 16.2 per cent of GDP to 16.4 per cent of GDP. This represents a nominal increase of 1.3 per cent.

345. Mr Speaker, the additional revenue of GH¢2.9 billion will come from the increase in revenues from the amendment to the Energy Sector Levies Act.

3.20 p.m.

Revisions to Expenditures

346. Mr Speaker, total expenditure on commitment basis has been revised downward to GH¢269.5 billion from the original budget projection of GH¢270.9 billion.

347. However, primary expenditure has been revised upwards to GH¢209.6 billion from the original budget projection of GH¢206.8 billion.

348. This upward adjustment reflects an increase in allocation to support energy sector payments.

349. Mr Speaker, Interest Payments have been revised downwards by GH¢4.3 billion, from the original budget projection of GH¢64.1 billion to GH¢59.9 billion.

350. Domestic Interest has been revised downward by GH¢5.1 billion mainly on account of gains from the reduction in the treasury bill rates, as a result of the implementation of our prudent debt management policies.

351. However, external interest payments have been revised upward by GH¢795 million to make additional provision for debt service due on post

cut-off date disbursements made by our bilateral creditors since 2023.

352. Mr Speaker, energy sector payments have also been revised upwards by GH¢2.9 billion, to provide for fuel purchases for power generation.

Overall Balance and Financing

353. Mr Speaker, notwithstanding the revisions to revenue and expenditure, the primary balance on commitment basis remains unchanged at a surplus of 1.5 per cent of GDP.

354. Based on the revisions to revenue and expenditure:

- i. The overall fiscal balance on cash basis improves from a deficit of 4.1 per cent of GDP to 3.8 per cent of GDP;
- ii. The overall fiscal balance on commitment basis improves from a deficit of 3.1 per cent to 2.8 per cent; and
- iii. The projected annual borrowing needs of government reduced by GH¢4.3 billion. Simply put, we would be borrowing by GH¢4.3 billion less.

Risks to the 2025 Fiscal Framework

355. Mr Speaker, despite the robust fiscal performance, there are underlying risks which pose a threat to the 2025 fiscal framework. These risks are:

- i. Shortfall in customs revenue;

ii. The smuggling of marine gas oil;

iii. Mounting wage pressures; and

iv. Pricing and award of contracts in foreign currency.

Mr Speaker, I would take them one after the other.

Customs Revenue

356. Mr Speaker, customs revenue recorded a significant shortfall of GH¢1.6 billion, even though the overall revenue is doing well, representing 12.7 per cent, for the first half of 2025.

357. This underperformance is attributable to systemic revenue leakages at key customs collection points, notably the Tema Port, and the smuggling of goods across our land borders.

358. These developments pose risks to the attainment of our revenue target for the year 2025.

359. To mitigate these risks, government is implementing the following measures to address existing operational challenges to safeguard revenue:

- i. Adopt the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools to minimise human interference in revenue assessment, supporting the validation of the country of origin, as well as the accuracy of classification and valuation of imported goods;

- ii. Roll out Advanced Cargo Information (ACI) system to ensure that the Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority (GPHA) and the Ghana Revenue Authority receive comprehensive shipment details at least 24 hours prior to vessel departure from the port of origin. This will enable pre-arrival risk assessment, reduce the need for documentation amendments and facilitate more accurate and timely duty assessments;
- iii. Implement a robust anti-smuggling surveillance programme targeting both inland and maritime borders; and
- iv. Review the institutional setup of the Customs Division of the Ghana Revenue Authority, including staff mobility, to facilitate the decentralisation of Customs operational risk to enhance transparency and accountability of staff.

Smuggling of Marine Gas Oil (MGO)

360. Mr Speaker, the tax exemptions on Marine Gas Oil (MGO) was introduced to support non-artisanal fishing fleet operating from Ghana.

361. Over the years, the tax exemptions have created incentives for abuse and smuggling of MGO onto the open market, resulting in revenue losses

estimated at nearly half a billion Ghana cedis every year.

362. The Government will withdraw the tax exemptions to curb smuggling and stem the erosion of tax revenue, thereby reducing the fiscal risks to the Budget.

Wage and Salaries Pressures

363. Mr Speaker, we have seen some significant pressures on the compensation budget for the first half of 2025 mainly emanating from wages and salaries.

364. Wages and salaries exceeded the Budget by GH¢1.3 billion for the first six months of the year.

365. The wage pressures were largely driven by last-minute recruitments undertaken by the previous NPP Government in the last quarter of 2024, especially in the education, health and security sectors.

366. In addition, ad-hoc reviews of conditions of service undertaken in previous years have distorted the Single Spine Pay Policy and further burdened the public wage bill.

367. Mr Speaker, Government is implementing the following measures to address the challenges:

- i. Conduct regular nationwide staff payroll audit to sanitise Government payroll;

- ii. Realignment of staff from overstaffed and defunct MDAs to areas with critical staffing needs;
- iii. Finalising the processes for the establishment of the Independent Emoluments Commission (IEC) as part of broader efforts to reform and reset public sector pay; and
- iv. Issue an Executive directive mandating all MDAs to seek approval from the Minister for Finance before making any commitments with financial implications on the payroll.

Pricing and Award of Contracts in Foreign Currency

368. Mr Speaker, the pricing of goods and services and the award of contracts in foreign currency pose significant risk to fiscal management with severe implications for the stability of our currency.

369. Unfortunately, foreign currencies are becoming the means of transacting business in Ghana. This trend if not checked, will erode the confidence in our currency, drive inflation, and result in the loss of value in the symbol of our sovereignty.

370. To curb this unfortunate development, H.E. President John Dramani Mahama has directed that beginning today 24th July, 2025, no contract awarded by government

irrespective of source of funding should be denominated in foreign currency.

371. We also want to use this opportunity to remind the public that per the Foreign Exchange Act, 2006 (Act 723) companies, institutions and individuals are prohibited from pricing, advertising, receipting or making payments for goods and services in foreign currencies in Ghana without written authorisation from the Bank of Ghana.

Update on Key Policy Initiatives

372. Mr Speaker, I now present updates on key policy initiatives outlined in the 2025 Budget.

3.30 p.m.

The Ghana Gold Board (GOLDBOD)

373. Mr Speaker, since its establishment in April 2025, the Ghana Gold Board (GOLDBOD) has initiated reforms to the licensing regime that governs the local gold trading sector and introduced new aggregation systems to effectively mop up gold from the artisanal, small-scale mining sector across the country.

374. These measures have already yielded tangible economic benefits within the short period of operation of the GOLDBOD.

375. In the first half of 2025 alone, gold exports from the small-scale sector stood at 51.5 tonnes, with an export value of approximately US\$5 billion.

376. This figure far exceeds the 26.4 tonnes with an export value of US\$1.8 billion from the small-scale mining sector over the same period in 2024.

377. Mr Speaker, simply put, gold exports, in tonnes, from the small-scale mining sector for the first half of 2025 recorded about 100 per cent increase, over what was recorded in the same period last year.

378. Similarly, the value of gold exports from small-scale mining increased by about 180 per cent for the first half of 2025, over that of the same period in 2024.

379. Mr Speaker, for the first time in Ghana's history, gold exports from the small-scale mining sector have exceeded gold exports from the large-scale sector.

380. The substantial foreign exchange inflows from the GOLDBOD's operations in the artisanal, small-scale mining sector, have significantly strengthened our reserves, improved our balance of payments and provided critical support to the Ghana cedi.

381. Mr Speaker, this tells a story. A story of a country which has been denied the full benefits of its gold resources.

282. A story of a country where illegal gold trade and smuggling have been allowed to fester to the detriment of the wellbeing of the people.

283. Mr Speaker, on the 8th July, 2025, His Excellency the President inaugurated

a task force to tackle illegal gold trade and smuggling.

384. I want to use this opportunity to reiterate that the government of President Mahama will deal ruthlessly with anyone found engaging in illegal gold trade and smuggling, as these nation-wrecking activities sabotage the progress of the people.

Mr Speaker, I also want to reiterate the point, that no one should come to us and beg because we will bot spare.

The 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme

385. Mr Speaker, earlier this month, President Mahama officially launched the 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme, Ghana's ambitious and integrated strategy to boost production, create sustainable jobs and modernise the economy.

386. The 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme represents a national reset aimed at reducing import dependence, expanding domestic production, improving market access and building a competitive, skilled workforce for a dynamic economy.

387. The anchor of the 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme is the Volta Economic Corridor, a transformational project to unlock the vast economic and

environmental potential of the Volta Lake and its surrounding lands.

388. The Volta Economic Corridor revives and expands on Dr. Kwame Nkrumah's original vision of the Volta Project as a hub for agro-industry, trade and transportation, now re-imagined to fit today's economic realities and regional opportunities.

389. The Volta Economic Corridor will be executed through the following pillars of the 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme:

- i. Grow24 will irrigate over 2 million hectares of farmlands for year-round farming instead of the traditional seasonal farming;
- ii. Make24 will establish agro-industrial parks for textiles, pharmaceuticals, and food processing;
- iii. Show24 will develop tourism clusters and hospitality hubs along the lake; and
- iv. Connect24 will turn the lake into a major inland transport route, cutting haulage costs and linking northern, southern, eastern, and western Ghana.

390. Mr Speaker, to support this transformative programme, the Ministry of Finance will, in the 2026 Budget, outline targeted incentives for the Volta Economic Corridor.

391. These measures will be carefully designed to attract private capital, drive enterprise growth and create decent, well-paying jobs. Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Finance will as part of the 2026 Budget outline a targeted incentive for the Volta economic corridor.

392. Mr Speaker, the government will only facilitate, and not dominate, this ambitious new growth pole.

The Big Push Programme

393. Mr Speaker, as part of the 2025 Budget we announced the commencement of the Big Push Programme, a flagship initiative of President John Mahama for massive infrastructure development.

394. Since then, the President has dedicated all Big Push budgetary allocations over the next two years to improve road infrastructure. *[Hear! Hear!]*

395. Mr Speaker may recall Parliament approved that all oil revenues and mineral royalties accrued to the Budget be dedicated to the Big Push.

396. As a result, the amount of GH¢13.8 billion which was allocated in the 2025 Budget to the Big Push Programme will be used for road infrastructure.

397. Mr Speaker, the Minister for Roads and Highways has spent the first six months of his time in office touring the whole country to assess, first hand, the state of roads in our country.

398. The Ministry of Roads and Highways has undertaken studies and prepared comprehensive engineering interventions and cost estimates for road projects under the Big Push Programme.

399. The Ministry of Finance has since issued commitment authorisations for the following road infrastructure projects under the Big Push Programme:

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> i. Construction of a new bridge on the Oti River at Dambai; [<i>Hear! Hear!</i>] ii. Rehabilitation of Wa — Han Road; iii. Upgrading of Tumu — Hamile Road; iv. Upgrading of Tumu - Han - Lawra Road; v. Reconstruction of Navrongo — Tumu Road; vi. Rehabilitation of Techiman — Nkonsia - Wenchi Road; vii. Rehabilitation of Wenchi — Sawla Road; viii. Construction of Sunyani Outer Ring Road; ix. Construction of Kumasi Outer Ring Road (Eastern Quadrant); x. Rehabilitation of Gbintri — Nakpanduri Road; xi. Rehabilitation of Dodo Pepesu — Nkwanta Road; | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> xii. Rehabilitation of Atimpoku — Asikuma Junction Road; xiii. Rehabilitation of Asikuma Junction - Anyirawasi Road; xiv. Reconstruction of Anyirawasi — Ho Tritrinu Road; xv. Upgrading of Akosombo-Gyakiti-Kudikope Road; xvi. Upgrading of Asikuma to Anum Boso-Kpalime Road; xvii. Upgrading of Adomi Bridge to Akwamufie Road; xviii. Rehabilitation of Ho — Kpetoe Road; xix. Rehabilitation of Kpetoe-Afiadenyigba Road; xx. Rehabilitation of Afiadenyigba — Penyi Road; xxi. Rehabilitation of Penyi — Aflao Road; xxii. Dualisation of Winneba — Mankessim Road; xxiii. Dualisation of Cape Coast-Takoradi Road; xxiv. Rehabilitation of Mankessim-Ajumako-Breman Asikuma-Agona Swedru Road; xxv. Rehabilitation of Tema — Aflao Road (Section 1); |
|--|---|

- xxvi. Reconstruction of Dodowa — Afienya-Dawhenya Road;
- xxvii. Upgrading of Oyibi-Appolonia — Afienya Road;
- xxviii. Construction of Enchi — Elubo Road;
- xxix. Construction of Dadieso — Akontombra Road;
- xxx. Upgrading of Adwofua — Oseikojokrom Road;
- xxxi. Upgrading of Enchi — Kudjouru - Pekyi Road; and
- xxxii. Upgrading of Bediako Junction — Camp 15 - Sefwi Adabokrom Road.

3.40 p.m.

400. Mr Speaker, as part of the Big Push Programme, we have also selected the following abandoned road projects, for which no dedicated funding was allocated by the previous administration:

- i. Rehabilitation and Upgrading of Kasoa - Winneba Road;
- ii. Rehabilitation of Ofankor — Nsawam Road (Dual Carriageway);
- iii. Dualisation of Takoradi — Agona Junction Road;
- iv. Construction of Suame Interchange and Local Roads;

- v. Construction of National Route N18: Wa - Han Road;
- vi. Upgrading of Tumu — Chuchuliga — Navrongo including construction of 36m span reinforced concrete bridge over Kanyibie River and 24m span reinforced concrete bridge over Bechelihi River;
- vii. Reconstruction of Navrongo — Chuchuliga - Sandema Road;
- viii. Rehabilitation of Tapa (Mabang) — Goaso Road;
- ix. Rehabilitation of Hohoe — Jasikan Road;
- x. Upgrading of Nkwanta — Oti Damanko Road;
- xi. Reconstruction of Have — Hohoe Road;
- xii. Dualisation of Adenta — Dodowa Road; and
- xiii. Reconstruction of Jinijini — Sampa Road.

401. Mr Speaker, in line with section 33 of the Public Financial Management Act and as part of this Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review of the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, I am seeking approval for these multi-year commitments

402. Mr Speaker, Government has also initiated comprehensive feasibility studies for four projects which are

currently at various stages of preparation, ensuring detailed assessments of their technical, economic and environmental viability.

403. The projects are:

- i. Accra - Kumasi Expressway on a completely new alignment;
- ii. Accra Outer Ring Road;
- iii. Kumasi Outer Ring Road; and
- iv. Adawso - Ekye Amanfrom Bridge to connect the Afram Plains area.

Reorganisation of the Road Fund

404. Mr Speaker, this is not all. The Government of President John Dramani Mahama has also taken a decision to remodel the Ghana Road Fund and refocus it towards road maintenance.

405. As part of this Mid-Year Review, and on behalf of government, the Minister for Roads and Highways will be laying before this House, a new Road Maintenance Trust Fund Bill.

406. When approved, the Road Maintenance Trust Fund will replace the Ghana Road Fund.

407. Mr Speaker, the Road Maintenance Trust Fund will, among others, provide for a new governance architecture, provide a formula for a fairer allocation of resources and

introduce more transparency in the utilisation of the road fund levy and others.

408. Government has identified 166 constituencies in dire need of road infrastructure. In response, we have programmed to rehabilitate 10km of roads annually in each of these constituencies. *[Hear! Hear!]*

409. Mr Speaker, this translates to about 5,000km of roads to be reconstructed in these 166 constituencies in dire need of road infrastructure over the next 3 years.

Nursing and Teacher Trainee Allowances

410. Mr Speaker, I am pleased to inform this House that we have paid all allowances due to nursing and teacher trainees from January to June 2025. *[Hear! Hear!]*

411. Mr Speaker, from the end of this month, July 2025, all nursing and teacher trainees will receive their allowances promptly, at the end of every month.

Mr Speaker, I will now move to the conclusion.

[Members of the Majority chant: "We want more"]

The Speaker: Hon Members, please we have other Businesses. It is not only this one.

Conclusion

412. Mr Speaker, I conclude this Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review with renewed hope and optimism.

413. The last six months have revealed our enduring spirit, what we can collectively achieve and our potential to rise from the brink.

414. Upon assumption of office in January this year:

- i. we were handed an economy in deep distress;
- ii. a country with dispirited citizens;
- iii. trust and faith in our leaders were at an all-time low;
- iv. the fundamentals were not only weak, but broken; and
- v. the misery and suffering were palpable. **[Some Hon Members: Oh!]**

415. In just 6 months, in fact, under 200 days, under the decisive leadership of President John Mahama, we have begun to change that story.

416. President Mahama's economic management model is working. The turnaround is in sight.

417. Mr Speaker, the signs of economic progress are visible and measurable:

- i. First quarter economic growth is at a 5-year high;
- ii. Our debt-to-GDP ratio is at a 5-year low;
- iii. Inflation has declined to a 4-year low;
- iv. Our credit rating has improved from junk to B-, with stable outlook, a two-notch upgrade and a 4-year high;
- v. We have almost reversed all the cedi depreciation in the years 2022, 2023 and 2024 with no cedi depreciation in the year 2025.
- vi. This level of appreciation of the Ghana cedi has never happened in the history of our nation;
- vii. Prices of petrol and diesel at the pump have reduced significantly to the benefit of consumers; and
- viii. Prices of sugar, rice and cooking oil at a 4-year low.
 - The price of a 25kg bag of Royal Aroma rice which used to be sold for GH¢650 in January is now being sold for GH¢356.
 - The price of *olonka* of sugar which used to be sold for GH¢50 in January is now being sold for GH¢44.

- The price of a 25litres of cooking oil which used to be sold for GH¢980 in January is now being sold for GH¢640.
- The price of *Kokonte* (1 sack) which used to be sold for GH¢1,200 in January is now being sold for GH¢950.
- A tonne of iron rods which used to be sold at GH¢9,400 in January is now being sold for GH¢7,500.
- Onion (1 paint bucket) which used to be sold at GH¢120 in January is now being sold for GH¢95.
- POP Cement which used to be sold for GH¢115 in January is now being sold for GH¢90.
- Maize (1 sack) which used to be sold for GH¢1,600 in January is now being sold for GH¢1,450.
- The price of Yazz Sanitary Pad which was GH¢25 in January is now going for GH¢15.
- Palm fruits (1 *Olonka*) which used to be sold for GH¢40 is now being sold for GH¢25.

3.50 p.m.

418. Mr Speaker, this is the reset President Mahama promised.

419. It has been six months of hard work.

420. We have lessened the burden on households and businesses.

421. Mr Speaker, contrary to the perception that we are not spending, we are, indeed, spending and spending at the right places. We are making the right investments in the lives of the people of Ghana. As we speak:

- i. An amount of US\$700 million as Eurobond obligations has been paid;
- ii. An amount of GH¢10 billion to domestic bondholders has been paid;
- iii. An amount of GH¢2.9 billion to the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) has been paid;
- iv. An amount of GH¢2.7 billion to the Social Security and National Insurance Trust (SSNIT) has been paid;
- v. An amount of GH¢9.1 billion to the energy sector for stable power supply has been paid;
- vi. An amount of GH¢5 billion of arrears has been paid;
- vii. An amount of GH¢4.6 billion to the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) has been paid;

- | | |
|--|---|
| <p>viii. An amount of GH¢1 billion to the Free Senior High School programme has been paid;</p> <p>ix. An amount of GH¢4.6 billion to the National Health Insurance Scheme has been paid;</p> <p>x. An amount of GH¢1.4 billion for National Health Insurance claims has been paid;</p> <p>xi. An amount of GH¢252 million for vaccines and essential medicines has been paid;</p> <p>xii. An amount of GH¢72.8 million as Capitation Grant has been paid;</p> <p>xiii. An amount of GH¢477 million to LEAP beneficiaries has been paid;</p> <p>xiv. An amount of GH¢895 million to the School Feeding Programme has been paid;</p> <p>xv. An amount of GH¢122.8 million for BECE registration has been paid;</p> <p>xvi. An amount of GH¢300 million to the No Fee Stress Policy has been paid;</p> <p>xvii. An amount of GH¢191.7 million as Teacher Trainee Allowance has been paid;</p> <p>xviii. An amount of GH¢462.6 million as Nursing Trainee Allowance has been paid;</p> | <p>xix. An amount of GH¢25 million as Assembly Members' Allowance has been paid;</p> <p>xx. An amount of GH¢21 million for the National Apprenticeship Programme has been paid;</p> <p>xxi. An amount of GH¢34.5 million to the Adwumawura Programme has been paid;</p> <p>xxii. An amount of about GH¢2 billion as goods and services to run effective and efficient Government Ministries, Departments, and Agencies has been paid; and</p> <p>xxiii. Mr Speaker, as we speak, an amount of about GH¢2 billion to save the National Investment Bank (NIB) has been paid.</p> <p>422. Mr Speaker, non-interest expenditures of GH¢84.2 billion have been paid — [Some Hon Members of the Majority: Has been paid!]</p> <p>423. So far, Mr Speaker, from January to June, a total cash of GH¢114.5 billion has been paid from the Consolidated Fund. [<i>Hear! Hear!</i>]</p> <p>Mr Speaker, we are spending in the right places. We are touching lives and changing our country.</p> <p>424. Mr Speaker, this is not all. We have also worked to:</p> <p>i. Improve the fiscal situation;</p> |
|--|---|

- ii. Restore fiscal discipline;
- iii. Implement appropriate policies to reduce interest rates significantly, thereby reducing the cost of borrowing; and
- iv. Save on domestic interest payments following the implementation of our prudent debt management policies.

425. Mr Speaker, there is still more work to be done. President Mahama is determined to deliver.

426. *Insha Allah*, H. E. John Mahama will deliver!

427. Mr Speaker, we are not out of the woods. It will be premature to make that pronouncement.

428. But the good news is that, today, hope is in sight and we are determined to navigate the country out of the terrible storm we inherited from President Akufo-Addo and Alhaji Bawumia.

429. We need the support of the people of Ghana to weather this storm.

430. Mr Speaker, to the farmer in Yendi and the fisherfolk in Sekondi and Shama, to the nurse in Sunyani and the teacher in Anum-Boso and Ajumako—

431. To the Ghanaian youth seeking decent work; to the elderly seeking better pension—

432. We see you. We hear you, and we are working for you. John Mahama will work for you and the NDC will work.

433. The gains we have made so far are the result of your sacrifice, your patience and our belief that change was not only necessary but crucial.

434. Mr Speaker, this Mid-Year Review is not just a technical report.

435. It is the story of the Ghanaian people: a story of a nation that refused to give up.

436. A story that echoes Nelson Mandela's quote, "It always seems impossible until it is done".

437. Mr Speaker, even as we look back at how far we have come, we are also looking ahead.

438. That is the essence of President Mahama's Leadership. He is focused and he will deliver.

439. President Mahama is honouring his promises to the Ghanaian people.

440. The second half of 2025 promises to be even better.

441. We expect inflation to continue its downward trend and reach our 2025 target ahead of schedule.

442. We will sustain the stability of the cedi through disciplined spending, targeted investment and continued reserve accumulation.

443. Growth will be further boosted by our strategic initiatives, including the 24-Hour Economy programme, the Big Push infrastructure programme and the revitalisation of agriculture through the Agriculture for Economic Transformation Programme.

444. Mr Speaker may recall that, during my vetting when asked what I would like to be remembered for as Minister for Finance, I stated that I would like to be remembered for stabilising the exchange rate, ensuring low prices and creating jobs.

4.00 p.m.

445. of the presentation of the 2025 Budget, my engagement with traders at the Makola market revealed that price and exchange rate stability were the overriding concern for the business community.

446. Mr Speaker, I wish to take this opportunity to thank our cherished traders at Makola for their valuable insights.

447. Mr Speaker, the updates on the cedi and the prices above clearly show that we have taken deliberate and decisive actions to ensure that the challenges, with exchange rates and prices, are tackled head on.

448. Mr Speaker, let me assure all Ghanaians that the stability in the exchange rate and the lower prices we are experiencing will be sustained.

449. Government has worked hard to bring down and stabilise the exchange rate with deliberate policies. It is now time for businesses to bring down prices to reflect the new economic reality. *[Hear! Hear!]*

450. We understand businesses went through some sacrifices during the turbulent economic challenges but so did the ordinary Ghanaian.

451. It is now time for prices to come down to reflect the new economic realities for the benefit of all Ghanaians.

452. Mr Speaker, as we look forward, more jobs will be created, confidence will deepen and the Ghanaian economy will stand tall again, not just in the sub-region, but on the global stage.

453. But to do this, Mr Speaker, we must stay united as a people and eschew divisiveness.

454. We must continue to have faith in our country, Ghana.

455. Mr Speaker, importantly, we must have faith in our currency, the Ghana cedi.

456. For 60 years, through cycles of inflation, devaluation, redenomination and recovery, the cedi has remained the symbol of our sovereignty:

- i. It has endured;
- ii. It has evolved; and

iii. It remains the only legal tender of our Republic.

457. Let us protect it. Let us trade with it.

458. Let us talk about it with pride, not as a burden, but as a badge of economic independence.

459. Mr Speaker, I believe in the cedi. Fellow country men and women, believe in the cedi.

460. To all of us who are privileged to serve in the leadership of our nation, let us unite and do this for ourselves, for our children and for our children's children.

461. It is our collective responsibility to reset our country.

462. Ghana needs us now more than ever. Our people need us!

463. Mr Speaker, I cannot conclude without expressing deep gratitude to H.E. President John Dramani Mahama, whose unwavering dedication and vision continue to anchor this national reset.

464. Mr Speaker, on a personal level, I thank H.E. the President because without him, this work could not have been achieved. He is, indeed, the anchor towards our economic reset.

465. And to you, Father, Mr Speaker—**[Some Hon Members of the Majority: Father oo Father!]**— Rt Hon Alban Sumana Kingsford Bagbin, our Father, and Members of Parliament and

the Parliamentary Service, I am extremely grateful.

466. Mr Speaker, indeed, #AbanPapaAba!!! *[Hear! Hear!]*

No wonder, my Brother, Kwamena, and his team had to flee the Chamber.

467. I salute, Mr Speaker.

I thank you for your kind attention.

[Some Members of the Majority rose and sang]

The Speaker: Hon Members, in line with the practice and convention of the House, I refer the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 financial year to the Budget Committee to be assisted by the leadership of the Finance Committee for deliberation and report to the House.

When it comes to the House, we will hear from the Chairman of the Committee, after they have gone through the Report, as to whether they second the Motion that has been moved or not. If they do so, then it will be opened for debate. This is a Motion, it is not a Statement, so Hon Members will have the opportunity to debate the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy Review of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana.

So, I intend to permit the Hon Minister to lay some of the Instruments that are clearly consequent on the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy just presented to us. If you

look at your Order Paper *Addendum*, you will see that we have captured Presentation of Instruments and also, the Presentation and First Reading of one Bill.

I intend to give him the opportunity to do so now, then we can make the references to the appropriate Committees, so that all these Committees can work together and report to the House for us to have a comprehensive report on what we just heard from the Minister for Finance.

We will start with the presentation and first reading of the Bill. Hon Members, the item numbered 1 on the Order Paper *Addendum* to be presented by the Minister for Finance.

BILL — FIRST READING

Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025

AN ACT to amend the Energy Sector Levies, Act 2025, Act 1135, to increase the rate of the energy sector shortfalls and debt repayment, levy marine gas oil in order to improve compliance and curb diversion of the product and provide for related matters.

*Presented by the Minister for Finance
(Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson) (MP).
Read the First time; referred to the
Finance Committee.*

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will now take item numbered 2(a) on the Order Paper *Addendum*—Presentation of Instruments.

4.10 p.m.

INSTRUMENTS

Public Private Partnership Regulations, 2025

*Laid by the Minister for Finance.
Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary
Legislation.*

The Speaker: We will now take the item numbered 2(b).

Fees and Charges (Miscellaneous Provisions) (Amendment) Regulations, 2025

*Laid by the Minister for Finance.
Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary
Legislation and Finance Committee.*

Mr Speaker: These Committee are needed to support at least the consideration of these Instruments.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, on your earlier referral of the Mid-Year Fiscal Policy to the Budget Committee, there is a request that they should be assisted by the Leadership of the Finance Committee. You know our present arrangements where the Budget Committee is chaired differently from the Finance Committee. So, I will crave your indulgence if we could make it a joint referral of both the Finance Committee and the Budget Committee because it is a multi-year commitment. So, Budget Committee and Finance Committee should handle this referral.

The Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, I have no problem with that at all. So, we will accordingly amend the earlier directive by referring the said Mid-Year Fiscal Review to a joint Committee of Finance and Budget.

Please, you know by our rules other Members are permitted to attend the Sittings of Committees, so any Member with interest or who wants to have a point put across is permitted to attend and contribute. They would not have a vote but at least they have the opportunity to make inputs into the Report. So, it is accordingly referred to a joint Committee of Finance and Budget for consideration and report to the House.

2(a) 2(b) are referred to the Committee on Finance and Budget Committee.

Hon Members, yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: There is a very strong lobbying for the Leadership of the Committee on Economy and Development to join the two Committees — just the Leadership of the Committee on Economy and Development, given that there is significant economic policy matters implicated in the discussions. So, if we could just add the Leadership of the Committee on Economy and Development.

The Speaker: I have a difficulty in adding the Committee on Economy and Development, because when you look at the Standing Order, the focus of that Committee has to do with matters

relating to the economy and development but emphasis on development planning. It is economy and development planning generally and the jurisdiction to investigate and enquire into the activities and Administration of Ministries, Departments and Agencies under the mandate of the Committee and the investigations and enquiry may extend to proposals for legislation.

If we open the floodgates as I have just eavesdropped, we may be called upon to add Committee on Ways and Means. That is why I added that Members are by our rules permitted to attend as Members of Parliament to contribute to the deliberations of the Committee. So let us leave it at the Joint Committee on Finance and Budget. I hope my Friends in the Committee on Economy and Development will not take issue with this.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the referral and the guidance. We believe that the two Committees will effectively perform the task that we have referred to them.

Mr Speaker, ordinarily when the Minister for Finance presents his budget or Mid-Year Fiscal Review and if my Friends opposite were there, we would ordinarily have an opportunity as Leadership to thank the Minister for the presentation of the Mid-Year Fiscal Review. I do not know if we will do that or we want to continue with other Businesses before us.

4.20 p.m.

The Speaker: Well, it is the pleasure of the House that the Leader should, on their behalf, express some kind words of gratitude to the Minister, why not? It will be permitted.

But let me just acknowledge the presence at the distinguished Visitor's Gallery of some National Executives of the National Democratic Congress. We have present with us, the National Chairman himself, Hon Johnson Asiedu Nketia. *[Hear! Hear!]* We also have the Chief Executive of the National Democratic Congress, the person of Fifi Fiavi Kwetey *[Hear! Hear!]*. And we have one of our former Leaders.

He recently left us voluntarily as a Deputy Minority Leader of our last Parliament, but now occupying a very privileged position. I am told he is now in charge of the Security and Exchange Commission. He is Hon James Klutse Avedzi, the longest-serving Chair of the Public Accounts Committee. We also have from the Bank of Ghana, the Governor of the Bank himself in the person of Dr Johnson Asiamah *[Hear! Hear!]*.

We have the first Deputy Governor, in the person of Zakari Mumuni —*[Hear! Hear!]*— and the second Deputy Governor, Matilda Asante Asiedu *[Hear! Hear!]*. Also with us are officials of the Ghana Revenue Authority. We have the Controller and Accountant General himself, Mr Anthony Kwasi Sarpong and the Commissioner in charge of the Customs Division,

Brigadier General—The writing is difficult to read. The person who wrote it, is it spelt “Annan” or A-N-A-A-N? Is that how it is spelt? We also have Dr Alex Adomako-Mensah, the Commissioner SSD of the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA). We have officials from the Ministry of Finance. The Chief Director, Dr Patrick Nomo, my former neighbour; the Chief Budget Analyst, Mr Isaac Fraikue; and the Coordinating Director, David Collison are here.

Please, next time, take your time and write the names—*[Laughter]*—I think the person was in a haste. So it is very difficult to read.

Hon Members, on your behalf, I warmly welcome them to the House and I thank them so much for their support, particularly the moral support they have given us. I hope they will appear before the Committee to assist the Committee in doing a good job, so that we do not leave any room for those who are absent to raise red flags.

We may now grant permission to the Majority Leader, if he wants to say a few words, to thank our Minister for Finance.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I want to, on behalf of my Colleagues in the House, thank the Minister for Finance for such a wonderful presentation. The Minister for Finance's delivery was splendid. We clearly understood every policy initiative that he has dealt with, how he has dealt with it, and what his plans are for the country.

Mr Speaker, I know, from a very personal level, that the last six months have not been an easy period for the Minister for Finance. It has been a very difficult period for him because he has had to deal boldly and decisively with issues that many who have come before him have hesitated to deal with. I want to assure him that this House stands solidly behind him in the performance of his duties. *[Hear! Hear!]*

We will continue to back him to ensure that the proposals that he brings to this House are expeditiously approved so that he can effectively address the challenges of this country. Mr Speaker, for once, I listened to a Mid-Year Budget Review without biblical quotations by Bible-wielding Ministers who have ended up digging a hole without a cathedral emerging. *[Laughter]*

The Speaker: Majority Leader, you have to thank the Minister for Finance. *[Laughter]*

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Minister for limiting the number of biblical quotations.

The Speaker: I do not want you to want to thank. Thank him and let us go. *[Laughter]*

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I am not surprised that our Friends opposite fled the Chamber before the Mid-Year Budget Review was presented. It is obvious that they have been monitoring the performance of the economy, and they knew that this Mid-Year Budget Review was going to unearth the

wastage, the thievery and the mess that was bequeathed to the NDC Government. The abysmal performance of our predecessors, and they knew that he is going to recount the very positive steps that have been taken in the last six months.

This is indeed the basis of the Minority fleeing the Chamber before the presentation of the Mid-Year Budget Review. Every Ghanaian knows that the incidents that happened in Ablekuma North are not grave to the extent that a whole Minority would refuse to listen to the Mid-Year Budget Review, which concerns the welfare of all Ghanaians.

The Speaker: Majority Leader, do not tempt me. [**Some Hon Members:** Father o Father!] Please.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I am still thanking the Minister.

The Speaker: You are to express the gratitude of the House to the Minister. Do not go into troubled waters. Just do that and let us move.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Minister for Finance for scaring and intimidating my Friends opposite.

Mr Speaker, on a more serious note, I think that we need to address the walkout. I am saying that the walkout is a result of the good news that the Minister for Finance was bringing. We thank him for bringing the Mid-Year Budget Review to us. We are very

grateful to him we continue to assure him of our support.

Thank you very much, Dr Ato Forson.

The Speaker: Hon Members, may I now refer you to Order Paper *Addendum* 2. We have one item there to deal with, which is the Presentation and First Reading of Bills. The Road Maintenance Trust Fund Bill 2025 by the Minister for Roads and Highways.

BILL — FIRST READING

Road Maintenance Trust Fund Bill, 2025

An act to establish the Road Maintenance Trust Fund to provide sustainable financing for the maintenance and rehabilitation of public roads, bridges and related infrastructure in the country and for related matters.

Presented by the Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza). Read the First time; referred to the Committee on Roads and Transportation.

The Speaker: I would want to yield the Chair to my Deputy so that you can continue with the other Business while I, as you all know, go to launch the second anniversary of the Democracy Cup. We need some of you to be present for me to do so.

Not all of you, because we have some Business to continue with. At least we should have a quorum to transact

Business, even if not to take decisions. The launch will not take a long time. After that, the other Members can come to join.

Please, First Deputy Speaker to take the Chair.

4.30 p.m. —

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[Pause]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, can we go to the main Order Paper and take item 7(c)? The Deputy Minister for Energy and Green Transition is—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, my attention has been drawn to the fact that we have not taken the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr Ayariga: Yes, Mr Speaker, we just want to vary the order of Business so that we can lay all the Papers, then we can go back to *Votes and Proceedings*. When they are laid and referred to the Committees, they can be working while we take the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 7(c), Presentation of Papers.

PAPER

By the Deputy Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr Richard Gyan-Mensah) on behalf of the Minister —

Work programme of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) for the year 2025.

Referred to the Committee on Energy.

Mr Ayariga: So, Mr Speaker, we can go back to *Votes and Proceedings*.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. The item numbered 5, Correction of *Votes and Proceedings*. The *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 23rd July, 2025.

Page 1...10—

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I was up on my feet from page 7, but it appears you could not see me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please go ahead.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, at the very first paragraph of the item numbered 7(b), the name “Asafo Adjei” should be hyphenated. So, the Clerks-at-the-Table could take note and correct accordingly. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table Office, cross check it.

Page 10...18—

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, at the third line of the item numbered 17 on page 18, there has been a repetition of the phrase, “the Government of”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are correct. Table Office take note.

Page 19...30—

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, there is a minor error at page 30, the item numbered 3(xi). I think the standard rendition of the portfolio of Mr Isaac Manu Owusu should be “Engineer, Health, Safety and Environment...” not “Environmental”. Because if we refer to the item numbered 3(vii) at page 29, the appropriate rendition is there.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table Office, cross-check.

Page 31

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 23rd July, 2025, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let us take item 7(a). The Report is ready for laying.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 7(a), by the Majority Leader.

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader—

2024 Annual National Progress Report of the National Development Planning Commission on the Implementation of

the Medium-Term National Development Plan Under the Policy Framework (An Agenda for Jobs II: Creating Prosperity and Equal Opportunity for All — 2022—2025).

Referred to the Committee on Economy and Development.

4.40 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance just stepped out to work with the Budget and Finance Committees on the Mid-Year Review. So, if we can have the Minister for Foreign Affairs lay item numbered 7(b) on behalf of the Minister for Finance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 7(b), Minister for Foreign Affairs.

By the Minister for Foreign Affairs on behalf of the Minister for Finance

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Security and Exchange Commission for the year 2024.

Referred to the Finance Committee.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we can have the Minister for Foreign Affairs lay the item numbered 7(d)(i)(ii) and (iii) and then 7(e)(i)(ii) and (iii) for us on behalf of the Minister of Environment, Science and Technology and then the Minister of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item number 7(d) at page 3 of today's Order Paper. We will take all of them together.

By the Minister of Foreign Affairs on behalf of the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Atomic Energy Commission for the year 2024.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for the year 2024.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Environmental Protection Authority for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology.

By the Minister for Foreign Affairs on behalf of the Minister the Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Information Technology Authority for the year 2024.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Data Protection Commission for the year 2024.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cyber Security Authority for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Information and Communications.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, can we take a short suspension for an hour, so that we can go and get the Committee Reports.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we are taking a short suspension. Accordingly, the House is suspended for one hour.

4.44 p.m. – *Sitting suspended.*

8.02 p.m. — *Sitting resumed*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order Paper *Addendum* 3, at the Commencement of Public Business – Presentation of Papers.

Yes, available Leader?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 1 on the Order Paper *Addendum* 3 – Presentation of Papers. We will call on the Chairman of the Finance Committee to lay the Report of the Finance Committee on the determination of the urgency of the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee, may we take the items numbered 1(i) and (ii) together?

PAPERS

By the Chairman of the Committee—

Report of the Finance Committee on the Determination of the Urgency of the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Report of the Finance Committee on the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, may we look at the item numbered 2 on the Order Paper *Addendum* 3 – Presentation of Instruments, Revenue Administration Regulations, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Finance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, let us take it one after the other. The item numbered 2(a).

INSTRUMENTS

Revenue Administration Regulations, 2025

Laid by the Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) on behalf of the Minister for Finance. Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary Legislation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the item numbered 2(b)?

**Judicial Service (Terms and
Conditions of Service)
Regulations, 2025**

Laid by the Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) on behalf of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary Legislation.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, may we now move to the Motion numbered 3 on the Order Paper *Addendum* 3. We have the Chairman of the Finance Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Finance Committee, you may move the Motion numbered 3 on the Order Paper *Addendum* 3.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two Sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Finance Committee on the determination of the urgency of the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025 may be *moved* today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has been ably

moved by the Chairman of the Committee; any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, may we now move to the Motion numbered 4 to be moved by the Chairman of the Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Finance Committee?

**Determination of the Urgency of the
Energy Sector Levies (Amendment)
(No.2) Bill, 2025**

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Finance Committee on the Determination of the Urgency of the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025.

In doing so, Mr Speaker, I would like to present the Report of the Committee.

Introduction

The Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 was presented to Parliament by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato

Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 163 of the House and read the First time on Thursday, 24th July, 2025.

The Minister for Finance in laying the Bill, informed the House that the Bill was of an urgent nature and, therefore, has not been *gazetted*.

Pursuant to Standing Order 160 of the House, the Rt Hon Speaker directed the Finance Committee to consider and report to the House as to whether the Bill was urgent or not.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Bill, met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, and officials from the Ministry of Finance.

Reference Documents

The Finance Committee referred to the following documents in the consideration of the Bill:

- i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992.
- ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana.
- iii. Energy Sector Levies Act, 2015 (Act 899).
- iv. Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) Act, 2025 (Act 1135).

- v. Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) Act, 2025 (Act 1141).

Object of the Bill

The purpose of the Bill is to amend the Energy Sector Levies Act, 2025 (Act 1135), as amended, to increase the rate of the Energy Sector Shortfall and Debt Repayment Levy on marine gas oil.

Observations

Loss of revenue

The Committee observed that Government has been supporting the fishing industry by providing subsidy in the sale of marine gas oil for the large commercial vessels.

Unfortunately, the subsidy has been widely abused as cartels have engaged in large scale smuggling of the product to the detriment of the fishing industry and the nation as a whole.

The Committee was informed that the main incentive for the smuggling was the price differential of the marine gas oil over that of other diesel products. Efforts to fight the canker was proving futile and Government was losing revenue daily as the smuggling persists.

The urgent passage of the Bill would timely address the issue and save Government revenue. Further, there would be no longer an incentive to smuggle the product. It is in this light that Government urgently needs to pass the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025.

Conclusion

After careful consideration, the Committee has determined that the Bill is of an urgent nature and, therefore, recommends its passage be taken under a certificate of urgency.

Mr Speaker, the purpose of the Bill is to remove the subsidies on the marine gas oil and introduce a levy of GH¢0.193. We considered this Bill together with the Deputy Minister for Finance and the Ministry of Finance team. We were informed that the Government introduced this levy with a view of supporting the fishing industry.

Unfortunately, Mr Speaker, it emerged that there is a cartel that is abusing this support that is supposed to help with the fishing industry by smuggling the marine gas oil and making the Government of Ghana lose substantial amounts of revenue that should have accrued to Government if taxes were imposed. Therefore, this tax is supposed to eliminate the differences between the diesel fuel supplies and that of marine gas oil in order to eliminate that incentive for the smuggling.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has been moved by the Chairman of the Committee and the Report has been duly presented. Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion and

make a few comments on the Report of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, we are talking about revenue issues here and we are trying to deal with smuggling of fuel subsidies that we give to the fisher folks. So, as soon as it is mentioned, if we do not deal with it, even if we give it two or three days, the cartel that we are trying to deal with will take advantage, buy the fuel, hoard them, so that within a week or a month, they can make some super abnormal profits.

So, we need to take the Bill through all the processes and get it passed, so that from tomorrow onwards, we can deal with the situation at hand. We do not need to waste time; we need to get it through all the processes, so that we can deal with the very challenge that we are trying to handle.

With these few observations, I call on Members to support the passage of the Bill through a certificate of urgency, so that we could get it done today.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we are talking about the urgency or otherwise of the Bill.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now we take the Motion numbered 5, that is the

Energy Sector Levies (Amendment)
(No.2) Bill, 2025.

8.12 p.m.

BILL — SECOND READING

**Energy Sector Levies (Amendment)
(No.2) Bill, 2025**

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) *on behalf of the Minister for Finance:* Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Finance Committee, you may now present the Report of the Committee.

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to support the Motion and in so doing, I present the Report of the Committee.

Introduction

The Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 was presented to Parliament by the Hon

Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 163 of the House and read the first time on Thursday, 24th July, 2025.

Subsequently, the Bill was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and Orders 160, 165 and 226 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Bill, met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem and officials from the Ministry of Finance.

Object of the Bill

The purpose of the Bill is to amend the Energy Sector Levies Act, 2025 (Act 1135) as amended to increase the rate of the Energy Sector Shortfall and Debt Repayment Levy on marine gas oil.

Structure of the Bill

The Bill amends the Schedule of Act 1135 as amended as follows:

Energy Sector Shortfall and Debt Repayment Levy	GHC 193 per litre on marine gas oil	For the payment of energy sector shortfalls, and energy sector legacy debts	Ghana Revenue Authority	Energy Sector Support Account
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Observations

Rationale for the Bill

The Committee observed that Government had recorded significant leakages that undermine the fairness and integrity of Government's fuel subsidy programmes, particularly those intended to support artisanal and commercial fishing activities. These leakages have created avenues for smugglers to profit from subsidies that are meant to alleviate the cost of operations for genuine fisher folks.

The technical team informed the Committee that the situation, not only deprives the State of critical revenue needed for social and economic development but also distorts the intended impact of these subsidies on the fishing sector.

The Deputy Minister informed the Committee that Government, as part of these measures intend to remove the price differential between marine gas oil and other diesel products by increasing the levy on the marine gas oil in order to improve compliance and curb diversion of the product. It is in furtherance of the initiative that the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 has been presented to the House for passage.

Support to small scale artisans and fisher folks

The Committee inquired whether the increase in the levy would adversely affect the activities of small-scale fisher

folks and artisans. The Deputy Minister indicated that the increase would not affect premix fuel which are mainly used by these small-scale fisher folks.

Support to Commercial fishing vessels

The Deputy Minister admitted that the repeal will adversely affect the activities of commercial fishing vessels. Government however intends to put in place mitigating mechanisms including tax refunds, to support the operations of the vessels.

Fiscal impact

The Committee was informed that the fiscal impact of the Bill would result in an increase in Government revenue to the tune of GHC71million.

Use of security to address the issue of smuggling of marine gas oil

The Committee inquired whether the security agencies could not be used to address the issue of smuggling rather than resorting to an increase in the Levy.

The technical team explained that Government has been combating the issue with the security authorities. However, due to the huge benefits derived from the smuggling of the product, the smugglers compromise some security officers as well as resist arrests by resorting to the use of fire arms.

The Bill would remove the benefit obtained in the smuggling as it would equate the price of marine gas oil to that of all diesel products. Government would also reallocate funds used in fighting the smuggling activities to more productive sectors of the economy.

Conclusion

After careful consideration, the Committee is of the view that the Amendment Bill is a step in the right direction, as it would go a long way to improve compliance and curb the diversion of marine gas oil in the Country.

The Committee, by consensus, accordingly recommends to the House to adopt its Report and pass the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion for Second Reading of the Energy Sector Levies Amendment (No.2) Bill, 2025 has been moved. The Report of the Finance Committee has been presented. It is now for the Consideration of the House.

Hon Members, let me remind you that at this stage, we debate the principle, the rationale, the mischief that the Bill is seeking to cure.

The floor is now open.

Yes, Hon Richard Acheampong

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, by way of seeking guidance, may we pray you to take only two contributions? —*[Interruption]*

No, Hon Sosu wants to also have a bite.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. I am amenable.

Hon Richard Acheampong?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to speak to the Report before the House and point out few observations.

Mr Speaker, when we met with the officials from the Ministry of Finance, initially, we wanted to find out because the Government had good intentions to give subsidies to the fisherfolks, so that at least it would lessen the burden of people who ply that trade.

But the information we got is that the very people that we are targeting are a smaller group. The people who buy the marine fuel operate the bigger vessels, and about 80 per cent of them are foreign-owned. So, the vulnerable that we are trying to support are not getting the benefits. And they buy the subsidised fuel, sell them, and make abnormal profits on it.

At the end of the day, we are not serving the very people that we want to serve. If you check the parent Act, the price of diesel was GH¢1.93 and that of marine fuel is GH¢0.23. If the Government brings it back to GH¢1.93, there is no motivation for any other person to buy and sell at GH¢1.93.

It is GH¢1.93 not GH¢0.23 any longer. So, there is no motivation for smuggling or any other under-dealings where the State will be losing, let us say the half year, about GH¢71 million. So, the whole year, we are looking at almost GH¢100 million lost to the State. If the State is losing GH¢71 million for 6 months, and the GH¢71 million would go to the very people that we want to support, then there is no problem.

But we have denied them this opportunity, we have denied the State the resources, and the target group is not also benefiting. It does not make any sense to maintain this kind of subsidy.

Mr Speaker, this is a very good move and the State will get resources. But let us bear in mind that there is still premix fuel and that is subsidised. Nobody should conclude by saying that Ghana has removed subsidy from marine fuel, so our people who are into that trade are going to suffer. No, they will still benefit under the premix arrangement. This is benefiting especially foreign vessels. I think it is in order. Let us support this Amendment so that the State will get the needed resources to do more projects for all of us.

With these few words, I thank Mr Speaker and I urge Members to support this Amendment.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Acheampong.

Hon Sosu?

Mr Francis-Xavier Kojo Sosu: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I also rise to speak in support of the Motion that the Report be adopted and this Bill passed.

Mr Speaker, purposely because I know that interventions are made to address specific challenges. This is a challenge that we have a targeted intervention which is not benefiting the intended beneficiaries. I believe that it is one of the very progressive tax handles or one of the very progressive policies that the Ministry of Finance has introduced to this House, and I urge all Members to support it.

Mr Speaker, the area that I had a lot of concern with is in paragraph 6.2 of the Report, where the question was asked as to whether this would affect small-scale fisherfolks and for the fact that the responses that were given by the Ministry shows clearly that small-scale fisherfolks would not be affected by this policy—For that reason, I believe that the entire House must support this policy so that Government can deal with this issue of smuggling.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Hon Deputy Minister for Finance?

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, I also rise to speak in support of the Motion for this House to adopt—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But you moved the Motion.

Mr Ampem: The Report of the Chairman of the Finance Committee. I am supporting him and seizing the opportunity to thank the House—
[Laughter]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But the House has not taken any decision.

8.22 p.m.

Mr Ampem: Mr Speaker, the issue at stake must be made clear that the subsidy we are seeking to remove does not affect the premix fuel that will be going to the artisanal fisherfolks; they are safe.

Mr Speaker, the marine gas oil is basically diesel and because of the subsidy, that has been made cheaper than the normal diesel that we send to the filling stations for the daily use by vehicle operators. Because of the price disparity, it has become a lucrative business for people to buy this fuel under the pretence that they are supplying them

to vessels for fishing and other purposes and then at the end, they divert them to the filling stations and sell them and make abnormal profit. This is why the Ministry of Finance is bringing this Bill to remove the incentive that enable people to smuggle this fuel.

In fact, we are told that if one goes to some of the shores like Prampram and others, it is a very normal business that one would see a lot of tankers going to fetch fuel from those vessels that are supposed to serve the coastal communities.

So, Mr Speaker, it is leading to loss of revenue to the State and the beneficiaries of this particular policy are not getting the benefit of it. And so, if we remove this subsidy, it is going to remove the incentive for anybody to engage themselves in this illegal act. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025 accordingly read a Second time.

BILLS — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025

Clause 1 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

First Schedule — Schedule to Act 1135 amended

Alhaji Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, just schedule to Act 1135 “the Energy Sector Levy, Act 2025, amended in the schedule by the substitution for paragraph ‘e’ of the second row ‘of’. I am referring to the ‘of’. Those of us who learnt modern drafting, what is the ‘of’ doing there?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, if you go to the second row, the ‘e’ is there that is, Ghana pesewas 193 per litre on marine gas oil.

Question put and Amendment agreed to.

First Schedule as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Long title ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that brings us to the end of the Consideration Stage of the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025.

Hon Members, the Motion numbered 7, on Order Paper Addendum 3.

BILLS — THIRD READING

Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP) *on behalf of the Minister for Finance:* Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025 be now read the Third time.

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

The Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No.2) Bill, 2025 — *read the Third time and passed.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. Mr Speaker, you may recall that you referred about 131 instruments to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration. The Committee has done its work and they have considered 130 instruments and that report is ready.

So, I want to pray you for a 30-minute suspension. Because the Hon Minister has been here since morning, so that we can prepare Addendum 4 and take that report. Then Mr Speaker, we can bring the curtains down on today’s proceedings, humbly submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. If the decision of the House is to suspend for 30 minutes, Hon Members, the House is accordingly suspended for 30 minutes.

8.31 p.m. — *Sitting suspended*

9.56 p.m. — *Sitting resumed*

Hon Members, let us turn to Order Paper *Addendum* 4: At the Commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers, the following Reports to be presented.

Hon Members, by the Order Paper *Addendum*, we seem to have several Reports. I will urge the Committee to put all the Reports together. The Report on the Timber Utilisation Contracts (TUCs) should be together.

Yes, it is by the Chairman of the Committee. Chairman of the Committee, you are laying the Reports.

Hon Members, the TUCs are about 131. Now, instead of taking the 131, can we not have one Report on the 131? Chairman of the Committee, can we have one Report covering all the 131? Very well. So, Chairman of the Committee, you may lay the Reports containing the 131.

PAPERS

By the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana, represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources, and 131 Reports as contained in the Order Paper *Addendum* 4.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to Order Paper *Addendum* 5, Presentation of Papers. The item numbered 1(i) to 1(v) on Order Paper *Addendum* 5.

Chairman of the Committee?

By the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem West (16.59 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem East (47.67 km²) in Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao

(33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion numbered 2 on Order Paper Addendum 5.

Chairman of the Committee? Yes, Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I would just want you to do something very small for me, which is, to allow the Deputy Minister for Finance to lay a Regulation and—That is the Revenue Administration Regulation, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It was taken.

Mr Ayariga: By who? Who laid it?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It was laid. It was laid by you. Have you forgotten? You laid two items together. It was done.

Mr Ayariga: All right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. It was done together with that of the Judicial Service. I think it was the Minister for Foreign Affairs who laid them instead of the Deputy Minister for Finance.

Yes, the Motion numbered 2.

Chairman of the Committee, page 2 of the Order Paper *Addendum 5*.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Order 104(1)

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining

of gold at Akyem West (16.59 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region may be moved today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved, any seconder?

10.06 p.m.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will take the Motion numbered 3.

**Mining Lease Agreement between
GoG and Newmont Golden Ridge
Limited at Akyem West and Akyem
East in the Birim North
and South Districts**

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem West (16.59 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

AND

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem East (47.67 km²) in Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Mr Speaker, in doing so, I wish to present the Committee's Report and urge that the *Hansard* capture the entire Report as having been read.

Introduction

On 18th July, 2025, the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah laid in Parliament two (2) Mining Lease Agreements between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Minister of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited in accordance with Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution and Section 5 (4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703).

The First Deputy Speaker subsequently referred the Mining Leases to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report pursuant to Orders 240(2) and 145 of the Standing Orders of the House.

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Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister of Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah, the Deputy Minister, Mr Yusif Sulemana and other officials of the Ministry to consider the Mining Lease. A team from the Minerals Commission led by the Chief Executive Officer, Mr Martin Ayisi also attended the meeting.

The Committee expresses its profound gratitude to the Hon Minister, The Deputy Minister and officials of the Ministry and Minerals Commission for their assistance during the deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;
- iii. The Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703);
- iv. The Minerals and Mining (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 900);
- v. The Minerals and Mining Act (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Act 995);
- vi. Minerals and Mining (Compensation and Resettlement) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2175);

- vii. Minerals and Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182);
- viii. Minerals and Mining (General) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2173); and
- ix. Republic v High Court, (General Jurisdiction 6), Accra; ex parte Attorney-General (Exton Cubic – Interested Party) [Unreported, Civil Motion No. J5/40/2018] dated 31st July, 2019.

Background Information

- 1.1 Newmont Golden Ridge Limited (NGRL) is a mining company incorporated under the laws of Ghana and operating within the framework of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703). In accordance with Section 5(1) of Act 703, the Company was granted the renewal of its Akyem East and Akyem West Mining Leases on 4th September, 2024. The Akyem East Mining Lease was renewed for a period of twelve (12) years, expiring on 3rd September, 2036, while the Akyem West Mining Lease was renewed for a period of five (5) years, expiring on 3rd September, 2029.
- 1.2 Newmont and NGRL have executed a Share Purchase

Agreement under which Gold Source International Holdings Company Limited ('Gold Source') together with Zijin Mining Group Co. Limited has agreed to acquire 100 per cent of the issued and outstanding shares of NGRL.

1.3 Gold Source International Holdings Company Limited ('Gold Source') is a limited liability company incorporated under the laws of the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region of the People's Republic of China. It operates as a wholly owned subsidiary of Zijin Mining Group Co. Limited (ZMGL), a joint stock company incorporated under the laws of China and listed on both the Shanghai and Hong Kong Stock Exchanges.

1.4 The total consideration for the Share Purchase Agreement was valued at One Billion United States Dollars (USD 1,000,000,000), to be paid in two tranches: an initial payment of USD 900 million upon the closing of the sale, and a subsequent payment of USD 100 million upon the fulfilment of certain conditions precedent, including the ratification by Parliament of the renewed Akyem East and Akyem West Mining Leases.

1.5 Although the Akyem Mining Leases were originally granted to

Newmont Golden Ridge Limited, the mine has since been acquired by Zijin Mining Group through its subsidiary, Gold Source. By a letter dated 17th April, 2025, Zijin formally notified the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources of the completion of the share transfer transaction, confirming that the takeover of NGRL was conclusively executed on 16th April, 2025. Upon receiving ministerial approval in accordance with Section 103(1) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703) and Regulation 3 of the Minerals and Mining (Licensing) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2176), the change in ownership was duly recognised.

1.6 NGRL was initially granted a fifteen-year mining lease on 17th January, 2010, which expired on 9th January, 2025. The Company commenced mining operations in 2013. Prior to the expiry of the lease, NGRL applied for renewal in accordance with the provisions of Act 703 and the Minerals and Mining (Licensing) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2176). Following a technical and economic assessment, including evaluation of the potential for underground mining, the Minerals Commission recommended the renewal of the leases. Consequently, pursuant to Section 5 of Act 703 and Regulation 195 of L.I. 2176, the Company was granted two new

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Mining Leases on 4th September, 2024.

Parties to the Mining Lease

The Parties to the Mining Lease are:

5.1. Government of the Republic of Ghana

The Mining Lease was executed by the Government of Ghana represented by the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural resources.

5.2. Newmont Golden Ridge Limited

Newmont Golden Ridge Limited

The Lease Area

The Mining Lease covers an area of 16.59 km² for Akyem West and 47.67 km² for Akyem East in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Tenure of the Mining Lease

The tenure of the Akyem East Mining Lease was renewed for a period of twelve (12) years, expiring on 3rd September, 2036, while the Akyem West Mining Lease was renewed for a period of five (5) years, expiring on 3rd September, 2029.

Justification

8.1 The Committee observed that ratification of the renewed mining lease by Parliament is a constitutional requirement

pursuant to Article 268(1) of the 1992 Constitution. The Company has demonstrated the requisite financial capacity, technical expertise, and qualified human resources necessary for the efficient operation of the Akyem Mine.

8.2 The Company currently provides direct employment to approximately seven hundred and fifty-seven (757) individuals and supports an estimated one thousand, two hundred and thirty (1,230) additional jobs through contractors and various mine support services. The Committee notes that failure to ratify the lease may result in the closure of the mine, with consequential adverse effects on employment and livelihoods, particularly within the host communities.

8.3 The mining operation also contributes significantly to national revenue through the payment of royalties, dividends, and taxes. Additionally, the Company has made substantial investments in social development initiatives in the host communities. These interventions, implemented through corporate social responsibility programmes, have contributed to the improvement of living standards and infrastructure in the mine's catchment areas.

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8.4 Additionally, adequate provisions have been made to address environmental concerns associated with the mining operations. A comprehensive Mine Operating Plan has been submitted by the Company to the Minerals Commission, in compliance with the Minerals and Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182). The Plan details the Company's mining and processing strategies, environmental rehabilitation measures, waste and water management protocols, internal monitoring systems, and emergency preparedness and response mechanisms. These measures are intended to ensure sustainable and responsible mining practices.

Observations

Ownership and Transfer of the mine

The Committee observed that on 9th October, 2024, Newmont Corporation, the sole shareholder of Newmont Golden Ridge Limited (NGRL), executed a Share Purchase Agreement with Gold Source International Holdings Company Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Zijin Mining Group Co. Ltd., incorporated under the laws of the People's Republic of China. Through this transaction, the entirety of Newmont's issued and outstanding shares in NGRL, totalling 8,226,215 ordinary shares, were transferred to Gold Source.

Following the consummation of the transaction, Zijin Mining Group, acting through its subsidiary Gold Source, became the ultimate beneficial owner of NGRL. The Committee further noted that the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, acting on the advice of the Minerals Commission and pursuant to Sections 52 and 100(2) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), granted formal consent to the transaction by letter dated 3rd January, 2025. The said letter constituted a "No Objection" from the Ministry and thereby legitimised the change in control of NGRL from Newmont Corporation to Zijin Mining Group.

The Committee noted that the Minister's approval was conditional upon the continued validity of all existing contracts and obligations of NGRL. Specifically, the approval required that all employment contracts and collective bargaining agreements be preserved, and that the Company's mineral rights agreements be deemed transferred to the new owner. In addition, Gold Source assumed responsibility for all associated liabilities as well as the continued development of the underground project.

The Committee was also informed that NGRL remains party to two key agreements governing its operations at the Akyem Mine, namely:

- i. a Mining Lease Agreement dated 19th January, 2010 and subsequently extended by the Government of Ghana; and

- ii. a Revised Investment Agreement (RIA) dated 4th May, 2015, which was ratified by Parliament on 26th November, 2015. Both instruments continue to govern the Company's operations and are subject to future review, renewal or amendment. It was further noted that Clause 1(j) of the Mining Lease expressly provides that the provisions of the RIA (and any amendments thereto) shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

The Committee is of the view that, based on the lawful transfer of ownership and governmental recognition of same, Newmont Corporation no longer retains any interest in NGRL and, consequently, is not entitled to any benefits or obligations under the Variation of Terms Agreement (VTA) currently under parliamentary consideration. It is the Committee's considered position that any rights, incentives, or fiscal benefits arising from the VTA accrue solely to Gold Source International Holdings Company Limited, as the new parent company, acting under the ultimate control of Zijin Mining Group Co. Ltd.

Accordingly, the Committee affirms that any reference to Newmont in the context of the VTA is merely historical and has no operative effect. The relevant corporate entity for all present and future engagements in respect of NGRL and the Akyem Mine is Gold Source International Holdings Company Ltd.,

under the ownership and control of Zijin Mining Group Co. Ltd.

Regulatory Oversight by the Minerals Commission

The Committee was informed that the Minerals Commission, as the regulatory authority responsible for the administration and enforcement of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), is mandated to ensure the Companies' compliance with the terms and conditions of the Mining Lease. In accordance with its statutory functions, the Commission is empowered to undertake routine and special inspections at the Lease Area as well as at the registered office of the Company to verify compliance.

The Committee further noted that, in the event of any breach of the provisions of the Mining Lease, the Minerals Commission is authorised to impose administrative penalties and sanctions against the Company. In particular, where the actions or omissions of the Company pose risks to the health and safety of persons, or result in damage to mining equipment and installations, the Commission has the authority to enforce penalties for which the Company shall be held liable.

Use of local content and local participation

The Committee was informed that the terms of the Mining Lease require the Company to comply with the provisions of the Minerals and Mining (Local

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Content and Local Participation) Regulations, 2020 (L.I. 2431). Specifically, the Company is obliged to engage the services of expatriate personnel only where necessary, ensure the training and capacity building of Ghanaian staff, and prioritise the procurement of local goods and services in the conduct of its operations.

The Committee further noted that non-compliance with the local content requirements constitutes a breach of the lease terms. In such circumstances, the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources is empowered to suspend the lease as a sanction for the violation.

Conclusion

The Committee has critically examined the Mining Lease within the ambits of relevant Legislations on the subject. Even more significantly, the Mining Lease does not violate the letter and spirit of Constitution. The Committee takes the considered view that the ratification of the Mining Lease would bring tremendous benefit to the Government and the socioeconomic development of communities in the mining area.

The Committee is also satisfied that the Company requesting for the Lease has the capacity to operate and maximise production to meet financial obligations stipulated in the Lease and recommends it for ratification.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this Report and ratify the Mining Lease granted to Newmont Golden Ridge Limited in accordance with article 268(1) of the 1992 Constitution and section 5(4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703) as amended.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, by the Order Paper *Addendum* 5, the Motions numbered 3 and 5 are talking about the same thing and are also contained in one Report.

Hon Chairman, is that correct?

Alhaji Dauda: That is so, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Motion moved; any seconder?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, this is just a very small correction. They are two different things, but they are contained in the same Report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion ably moved by the Committee Chairman. In doing so, as he has alluded to, the Report was referred to us and we met the Ministry and its agencies. And having perused all the documents presented to us, we realised that all the requirements in the Act were

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all met. We asked for certain documents and they were all presented.

Looking at how minerals support the country: the employment avenues and other social corporate responsibilities, especially in the catchment areas, the Committee is of the view that we rectify the concession for the agreement for the company to be able to operate. It is creating both direct and indirect jobs for the teeming youth and it is generating revenue for the Government. So, we ask the House to support and adopt the Report.

Question proposed.

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker, I rise to support the Motion and to urge Members to ratify these two leases. And they are being ratified in accordance with Section 5(1) of the Mining and Minerals Act, 2006 (Act 703). These two leases, Mr Speaker, were all approved in 2024 under the previous Government.

We perused the leases, re-engaged the companies, and the benefits to the state are enormous. First, in the agreement, we have laid out that they will transfer local expertise to Ghanaians. We emphasise local content and other infrastructure development. We see that an operational cash flow of 1.22 billion will be invested and an amount of almost 500 million will accrue to the state, and royalties of over 200 million.

I, therefore, urge Members to adopt and ratify the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Suhuyini?

Deputy Minister for Roads and Highways (Alhaji Suhuyini Sayibu Alhassan) (MP): Mr Speaker, I want to associate with earlier calls on Colleagues to ratify these leases for Newmont Golden Ridge Limited.

Mr Speaker, if you look at the operations of Newmont in these communities, we have come to learn as Members of the Committee, that they also support the community members through their corporate social responsibilities and others.

Mr Speaker, again, we have examined all the documents that were requested of them and we are convinced that they meet the legal requirements that should enable us to grant them this ratification. This would also add value to their operations and make it easier for them to expand and invest more in these concessions and I just want to add my voice to the earlier call by Colleagues that we ratify this for the mining industry to improve.

10.16 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let me, again, reiterate the fact that the Motions numbered 3 and 5 are dealing with two separate items contained in the same Report. So, I deem

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it that these two Motions are taken together. So, I will put the Question.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think the Motion specifically refers to Akyem East—*[Interruption]*—All right, explain to him what the issue is.

Mr Buah: Mr Speaker, I think you are right. We are taking them together, but they are Akyem East and Akyem West.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Motion numbered 5 is Akyem East and then the Motion numbered 3 is Akyem West, but they are both contained in one Report to be adopted. So, by necessity, we cannot adopt this particular Report without taking into consideration the Motions numbered 3 and 5, unless we want the Motion numbered 5 to, again, be moved.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker if you would recall, you guided, but I also indicated that Motions 3 and 5 are contained in one Report but are of two different—One is 16.6 and the other is 47.67, but for the convenience, that is why the Committee decided to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the Motion numbered 3 was to adopt the Committee's Reports. Now the Motion numbered 5 was also to adopt the same Committee's Reports. So, the Report contained the two mining leases. So, once this Report is adopted, it takes care of Motions numbered 3 and 5.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that was the guidance you gave before he moved it.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, Chairman of the Committee, you may move the Motion numbered 6 on today's Order Paper.

MOTION

Suspension of Order 104(1)

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region may be *moved* today.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Motion numbered 7, Chairman of the Committee.

Mining Agreement Between GoG and Gateway Exploration Limited for the Mining of Gold at Obobetwao

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Mr Speaker, in so doing, I present the Report of the Committee and urge that the *Hansard* captures the entire Report as having been read, as I read the introduction and the conclusion.

Introduction

1.1 The Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah, on Friday, 18th July

2025 presented to the House, Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region. The Minister requested parliamentary ratification pursuant to Article 268(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992 and section 5 (4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), as amended.

1.2 The Mining Lease was subsequently referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report in accordance with Orders 97(5) & 240 of the Standing Orders.

Deliberations

2.1 The Committee, in its deliberations, met with the Hon Minister for Lands & Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah, the Hon Deputy Minister for Lands & Natural Resources, Mr Yusif Sulemana, the Acting Chief Director of the Ministry of Lands & Natural Resources, Mr Innocent Haligah, the Chief Executive of the Minerals Commission, Mr Martin Kwaku Ayisi, and other senior officers of the Ministry and the Minerals Commission.

2.2 The Committee is grateful to the stakeholders and experts consulted for their valuable inputs.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following relevant documents during its deliberations:

- a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- b. The Standing Orders of Parliament 2024;
- c. The Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703);
- d. The Minerals and Mining (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 900);
- e. The Minerals and Mining (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Act 995);
- f. The Minerals and Mining (Compensation and Resettlement) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2175);
- g. The Minerals and Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182);
- h. The Minerals and Mining (General) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2173);
- i. The Minerals and Mining (Licensing) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2176);
- j. The Minerals and Mining (Local Content and Local Participation)

Regulations, 2020 (L.I. 2431); and

- k. The Supreme Court decision in the case of Republic v High Court, (General Jurisdiction 6), Accra; ex parte Attorney-General (Exton Cubic – Interested Party) [Unreported, Civil Motion No. J5/40/2018] dated 31st July, 2019.

Background Information

4.1 Gateway Exploration Limited is a mining company incorporated under the laws of Ghana. In accordance with section 5(1) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), the Company's mining lease was granted on 29th November, 2024 for a term of fourteen (14) years ending 28th November 2038. The lease granted to the Company covers an area of 33.37 km² located at Obobetwao in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

4.2 Prior to the grant and execution of the said lease to Gateway Exploration Limited, the Minerals Commission thoroughly reviewed the Company's application, including its comprehensive feasibility report as well as its technical and financial capacity, as mandated by law. The Minerals Commission assured the Committee of its satisfaction with the capacity of the Company to undertake the mining, having met the conditions precedent.

Structure and Content of the Company's Mining Lease Agreement

5.1 The Mining Lease Agreement entered into with the Gateway Exploration Limited was prepared in compliance with domestic industry legislation and international best industrial practice. Some of the key provisions in the Agreement include the following:

- a. Clause 1(f)—The Company shall not conduct any operations in a reserved area, restricted area, protected area or designated area and shall not without the prior written consent of the Minister conduct any operations:
 - i. Within 100 metres of any forest reserve, river, stream, building, installation, reservoir, dam, public road, railway or area appropriated for a railway; or
 - ii. Within 300 metres of a pylon; or
 - iii. In an area occupied by a market, burial ground, cemetery or within a town or village or an area set apart for, used, appropriated or dedicated to a public purpose.
 - iv. Where the lease area affects existing roads and passage ways, the Company shall permit the public to use any roads constructed by the Company and shall label permissible roads as such in accordance with the

provisions of Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182)

- b. Clauses 4 and 5 provides for the Company's work obligation and the conduct of operations, requiring that the company operates in the Lease Area in accordance with applicable laws and regulations and consistent with good mining practices, ensuring conservation of resources, reclamation of land and protection of the environment. The Company is under obligation to maintain all equipment in good repair and keep all working areas in good safe condition and take all practical steps to:
 - i. prevent damage to adjoining farms and villages;
 - ii. avoid damage to land, trees, crops, buildings, structures and other property in the Lease Area.
- c. Clause 6 enjoins the Company to notify the Government of the Ghana of the discovery of other minerals.
- d. Clauses 8 & 9 provides for Health, Safety, and Environmental Protection, as well as power of the Minerals Commission to enter concession area and execute certain remedial actions remedial actions and the Company shall be liable to pay a penalty and the cost of any remedial actions incurred in the by the Commission is executing such corrective actions.

- e. Clauses 11 and 12 provides for Local Content and Local Participation.

Observations

Corporate Social Responsibility

The proposed mining project is expected to deliver positive socio-economic impacts within the catchment area by generating employment for local youth and stimulating local commerce. However, the committee observed that mining communities often remain underdeveloped despite ongoing operations. As a result, there is a recognized need for legislation to make the development of mining communities a mandatory component of Corporate Social Responsibility initiatives.

6.1.2 The Company proposes the following priority areas for their Corporate Social Responsibility:

a. **Education and skills development**

Scholarships and bursaries for tertiary and technical education. Support for technical education will target youth interested in developing their skills in craft and artisanship e.g. dump truck operators, auto-mechanics, welders, carpenters, hospitality stewards, etc. The Company proposes to integrate skills training with the its operational requirements.

b. **Health infrastructure and services**

Construction of wards at District Hospitals, Clinic/CHIPs Compounds in local communities, donation of medical equipment, short-term staff development training.

c. **Local economic development**

Sponsorship for agriculture-based initiatives, example, National Farmers Day, Training and technical support for women in agro-processing initiatives, crop-based livelihoods activities linked with livelihood restoration programs for project-affected persons. The local employment strategy is to recruit 70 per cent of unskilled labour from affected communities.

d. **Water and sanitation**

Provision of boreholes and small-town water systems, provision of household latrines.

Financial Impact

6.2.1 The Committee noted that the request for ratification places no financial burden on the Government. It is estimated that an amount of Two Hundred Sixteen Million, Nine Hundred and Twenty Thousand United States dollars (USD\$216,920,000) would accrue as gross revenue over the Lease's term of 14 years.

6.2.2 Government would also benefit immensely through taxes, fees, and royalties that would accrue if Gateway Exploration Limited Lease is ratified. The project is expected to generate a total of US\$53.63 million to Government, comprising US\$10.85 million in royalties and US\$42.78 million in corporate income taxes, apart from providing employment to the youth within and beyond the operational area.

Economic and operational readiness of Leaseholders

It was brought to the attention of the Committee that delay in ratifying the lease for the company is impeding the companies' ability to unlock further financing from banks and capital markets—thus stalling full-scale operations and planned expansions. The Committee acknowledges that timely ratification is critical to preserving investor confidence and ensuring continuity in resource development.

Enforcement of compliance with terms of the Lease

The Committee was informed that the Minerals Commission has the responsibility to ensure compliance with the provisions of the Mining Lease. The Commission has the power to undertake inspections at the Lease area or the registered office of the Company.

The Commission is also empowered to exact penalties if the company fails to comply with any provision of the Mining Lease. Should the Company take actions

that endanger the health and safety of persons or damage mining equipment and installations, the Commission has the power to impose penalties for which the Company is liable to pay.

Recommendations and Conclusion

7.1 The Committee, after having examined the Mining Lease within the ambits of relevant legislations on the subject, is of the opinion that the ratification of the Mining Lease would bring tremendous benefit to the country, including socio-economic development to communities in the mining area.

7.2 The Committee is also satisfied that the Company requesting for the Lease has the capacity to operate and maximise production to meet financial obligations stipulated in the Lease and recommends it for ratification.

7.3 The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this Report and pursuant to Article 268(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992 and section 5(4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), ratify the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Respectfully Submitted.

*Mining Agreement Between GoG and Gateway Exploration Limited for the
Mining of Gold at Obobetwao*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has moved and the Report presented; is there any seconder?

10.26 p.m.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

At the Committee's meeting, I must say that the company has met all the requirements for the agreement and what fascinated the Committee most was the Corporate Social Responsibility priorities and activities that they set in place. The Corporate Social Responsibilities that they presented to us that they are going to help the catchment area with include; education and skills development, health infrastructure and services, local economic development, and water and sanitation. The Committee realised that they prioritised local content for the employment of the youth within the catchment area.

Against this background, the Committee recommends that the Agreement should be ratified.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion is moved and seconded. The Report is presented and it is for the consideration of the House.

Yes, Hon Suhuyini?

Alhaji Suhuyini Sayibu Alhassan: Mr Speaker, I wish to join my

Colleagues in calling for us to ratify this Agreement for the Gateway Exploration Limited.

Mr Speaker, I am particularly excited that we are doing this today given the history of us not bringing such agreements to Parliament for ratification. Mr Speaker, it was the reason some of us went to court in 2018 to demand that all mining agreements that were not ratified be considered null and void owing to a Supreme Court ruling at the time.

Mr Speaker, when we examined the documentation, we came to the conclusion that indeed the company's comprehensive feasibility report was intact and was also going to benefit us. Its technical and financial capacities were not in doubt.

Mr Speaker, we were also particularly excited to note that the company was not to conduct any operations in a reserved area, restricted area, protected area or designated area and they were not also permitted to conduct operations within 300 metres of any pylon or 100 metres of any forest reserve, river stream, building installation, reservoir, dam, public road, railway or area appropriated for railway. Mr Speaker, this lease is for 14 years and once it is ratified it is expected that government will accrue a revenue of about US\$216 million.

Mr Speaker, on this note, I once again call on Colleagues to join us to ratify this mining lease between the Government of Ghana and Gateway Exploration Limited.

*Mining Agreement Between GoG and Gateway Exploration Limited for the
Mining of Gold at Obobetwao*

I thank you.

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I just want to add my voice to urge Members to ratify the mining lease for Gateway. They have met the technical and financial requirements and this exercise is grounded in Article 268(1) of the Constitution and the other basis is that it will inure to the benefit of the State financially, create jobs and help with the economy.

On that note, I urge Members to ratify this Agreement.

I thank you.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Motion numbered 8, Chairman of the Committee?

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has been moved and seconded.

It is for the consideration of the House. Hon Members, this is a procedural Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Motion numbered 9, Chairman of the Committee?

Mining Lease Agreement between GoG and GBF Associates Ghana Limited

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): I beg to *move*:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman, in doing so, present the Committee's Report.

Alhaji Dauda: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

In presenting the Report, I wish to seek your permission to read the Introduction and the Conclusion and ask that the *Hansard* captures the whole Report as having been read.

Introduction

The Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah Kofi Buah, on Friday, 18th July, 2025 presented to the House, Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF

Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region. The Minister requested parliamentary ratification pursuant to Article 268(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992 and section 5 (4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), as amended.

Consequent to the presentation, Mr Speaker referred the Mining Lease Agreement to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report in accordance with Orders 97(5) and 240 of the Standing Orders.

Deliberations

Present at the meetings of the Committee, were the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah, the Hon Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Yusif Sulemana, the Acting Chief Director of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Innocent Haligah, the Chief Executive of the Minerals Commission, Mr Martin Kwaku Ayisi, and other senior officers of the Ministry and the Minerals Commission.

The Committee is grateful to the stakeholders and experts consulted for their valuable inputs.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following relevant documents during its deliberations:

- a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- b. The Standing Orders of Parliament 2024;
- c. The Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703);
- d. The Minerals and Mining (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 900);
- e. The Minerals and Mining (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Act 995);
- f. The Minerals and Mining (Compensation and Resettlement) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2175);
- g. The Minerals and Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182);
- h. The Minerals and Mining (General) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2173);
- i. The Minerals and Mining (Licensing) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2176);
- j. The Minerals and Mining (Local Content and Local Participation) Regulations, 2020 (L.I. 2431); and
- k. The Supreme Court decision in the case of *Republic v High Court, (General Jurisdiction 6), Accra; ex parte Attorney-General (Exton Cubic – Interested Party)* [Unreported, Civil Motion No. J5/40/2018] dated 31st July, 2019.

Background Information

GBF Associates Ghana Limited is a mining company incorporated under the laws of Ghana. In accordance with section 5(1) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), the Company's mining lease was granted on 30th May, 2024 for a term of 22 years ending 28th May, 2046. The lease granted to the Company includes the mining of gold and other minerals at Ntotroso and covers an area of 49.77 km² in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Before the grant and execution of the said lease to GBF Associates Ghana Limited, the Minerals Commission thoroughly reviewed the Company's application, including its comprehensive feasibility report as well as its technical and financial capacity, as mandated by law. The Minerals Commission assured the Committee of its satisfaction with the capacity of the Company to undertake the mining, having met the conditions precedent.

Structure and Content of the Company's Mining Lease Agreement

The Mining Lease Agreement entered into with the GBF Associates Ghana Limited was prepared in compliance with domestic industry legislation and international best industrial practice. Some of the key provisions in the Agreement include the following:

- a. Clause 1(f)—The Company shall not conduct any operations in a reserved area, restricted area, protected area or designated area

and shall not without the prior written consent of the Minister conduct any operations:

- i. Within 100 metres of any forest reserve, river, stream, building, installation, reservoir, dam, public road, railway or area appropriated for a railway; or
- iii. Within 300 metres of a pylon; or
- iv. In an area occupied by a market, burial ground, cemetery or within a town or village or an area set apart for, used, appropriated or dedicated to a public purpose.
- v. Where the lease area affects existing roads and passage ways, the Company shall permit the public to use any roads constructed by the Company and shall label permissible roads as such in accordance with the provisions of Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182)
- b. Clauses 4 and 5 provides for the Company's work obligation and the conduct of operations, requiring that the company operates in the Lease Area in accordance with applicable laws and regulations and consistent with good mining practices, ensuring conservation of resources, reclamation of land and protection of the environment. The Company is under obligation to maintain all

equipment in good repair and keep all working areas in good safe condition and take all practical steps to:

- i. prevent damage to adjoining farms and villages;
- ii. avoid damage to land, trees, crops, buildings, structures and other property in the Lease Area.
- c. Clause 6 enjoins the Company to notify the Government of the Ghana of the discovery of other minerals.
- d. Clauses 8 and 9 provide for Health, Safety, and Environmental Protection, as well as power of the Minerals Commission to enter concession area and execute certain remedial actions and the Company shall be liable to pay a penalty and the cost of any remedial actions incurred in the by the Commission is executing such corrective actions.
- e. Clauses 11 and 12 provide for Local Content and Local Participation.

Observations

Corporate Social Responsibility

The proposed mining project is expected to deliver positive socio-economic impacts within the catchment area by generating employment for local youth and stimulating local commerce. However, the committee observed that mining communities often remain

underdeveloped despite ongoing operations. As a result, there is a recognised need for legislation to make the development of mining communities a mandatory component of Corporate Social Responsibility initiatives.

The Company proposes the following priority areas for their Corporate Social Responsibility:

a. Education and skills development

Scholarships and bursaries for tertiary and technical education. Support for technical education will target youth interested in developing their skills in craft and artisanship, for example, dump truck operators, auto-mechanics, welders, carpenters, hospitality stewards, etc. The Company proposes to integrate skills training with the its operational requirements.

b. Health infrastructure and services

Construction of wards at District Hospitals, Clinic/CHPs Compounds in local communities, donation of medical equipment, short-term staff development training.

c. Local economic development

Sponsorship for agriculture-based initiatives, for example, National Farmers Day, Training and technical support for women in agro-processing initiatives, crop-based livelihoods activities linked with livelihood restoration programs for project-affected persons. The local employment strategy

is to recruit 70 per cent of unskilled labour from affected communities.

d. Water and sanitation

Provision of boreholes and small-town water systems, provision of household latrines.

Financial Impact

The Committee was informed that the request for ratification places no financial burden on the Government. The Ntotroso operations by GBF Associates Limited is estimated to generate US\$253,180,000 would accrue as gross revenue over the Lease's term of 22 years. Government would also benefit immensely through taxes, fees, and royalties that would accrue if GBF Associates Limited Lease is ratified.

Environmental Impact

It is also observed that the Company has committed to environment protection as part of their corporate business strategies and in line with general regulatory requirement and Ghana's Health Safety, and Environmental Policy.

The Company has a documented procedure and process for dealing with such environmental issues such as air quality, surface water, flora and fauna, noise and vibration, soil conservation, biophysical setting, groundwater quality, solid and liquid waste management and soil restoration.

The Company is committed to rehabilitation and preparing Mine Closure reports with the goal of restoring the environment to its original condition. This process includes the restoration of water bodies, improvement of air quality, replanting trees, establishing cash crops, and repairing infrastructure on arable lands, including dams, tailings dams, ponds, and other essential elements.

Mine Closure reports will be submitted to the Minerals Commission at least 60 days prior to the abandonment or closure of the mines.

Economic and operational readiness of Leaseholders

It was brought to the attention of the Committee that delay in ratifying the lease for the company is impeding the companies' ability to unlock further financing from banks and capital markets—thus stalling full-scale operations and planned expansions. The Committee acknowledges that timely ratification is critical to preserving investor confidence and ensuring continuity in resource development.

Enforcement of compliance with terms of the Lease

The Committee was informed that the Minerals Commission has the responsibility to ensure compliance with the provisions of the Mining Lease. The Commission has the power to undertake inspections at the Lease area or the registered office of the Company. The Commission is also empowered to exact

penalties if the company fails to comply with any provision of the Mining Lease. Should the Company take actions that endanger the health and safety of persons or damage mining equipment and installations, the Commission has the power to impose penalties for which the Company is liable to pay.

Recommendations and Conclusion

The Committee, after having examined the Mining Lease within the ambits of relevant legislations on the subject, is of the opinion that the ratification of the Mining Lease would bring tremendous benefit to the country, including socio-economic development to communities in the mining area.

The Committee is also satisfied that the Company requesting for the Lease has the capacity to operate and maximise production to meet financial obligations stipulated in the Lease and recommends it for ratification.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this Report and pursuant to Article 268(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992 and section 5(4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), ratify the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Respectfully Submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion moved and Report presented. Any seconder?

10.36 p.m.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): I rise to second the Motion and in so doing make few comments.

The Committee observed that the company has aligned a lot of Corporate Social Responsibilities (CSR). One of the questions we asked was for their environmental protection assessment reports which they were able to produce. They had an EPA permit to operate. Mr Speaker, the company would generate a revenue of GHC253,180,000 to be accrued to the Republic of Ghana if this mining lease is ratified. So, looking at this and other benefits, we recommend the adoption of the ratification. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Alhaji S. S. Alhassan: Mr Speaker, I also call on Members to join us to ratify this lease between the government of the Republic of Ghana and GBF Associates, Ghana Limited.

Mr Speaker, except to note that in line with the previous leases, it ought to be emphasised that this ratification is to allow the company to mine gold and if there are other minerals detected, the law indicates how it is to be mined. But this lease is limited to the mining of gold and that is in line with the other leases that we have already ratified.

It is stated here that mining of gold and other minerals at Ntoroso, even though it is a template that is often used in many of the mining agreements, it is understood to mean that there are other laws that will kick in if other minerals are determined on the concession that the lease has been granted. So, Mr Speaker, I just want to make that point as we seek ratification for this particular lease agreement.

Mr Speaker, it is also imperative to note that these ratifications are not only constitutionally imperative but they are also a process of value addition. This is because it is clearly noted that a delay in ratifying this lease for the company is impeding the company's ability to even unlock further financing from banks and capital markets, thus stalling full-scale operations and planned expansions. That is why it is important that these ratifications are taken seriously, and companies seek these parliamentary ratifications not only because it is constitutionally prudent but it is also a process of value addition.

Mr Speaker, because of the benefits that the country would get from the operations of this company, I call on Members to join us to ratify this mining agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana and GBF Associates Ghana Limited. Thank you.

Mr Buah: Mr Speaker, I add my voice to urge Members to ratify this agreement. I just want to note that this lease was approved on the 30th of May, 2024 for a term of 22 years. The company has already invested in this lease that was

granted and it is necessary for us to approve it. It is also important to note that the state has a 10 per cent Free Carried Interest (FCI). And apart from the constitutional imperative, there are financial benefits and other job opportunities, infrastructure development that will accrue. I ask Members to ratify that.

Mr Philip Fiifi Buckman (NDC — Kwesimintsim): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I would want to also add my voice and call upon Members to ratify this lease agreement. Mr Speaker, I am very happy with the Report by the Committee. Especially looking at the fact that they informed us that clause 4 and 5 of the agreement provides for the company's work obligation, the conduct of operations requiring that the company operates in the lease area in accordance with good mining practises, ensuring conservation of resources, reclamation of the land, and protection of the environment.

This is important because, Mr Speaker, we have been saddled with various destruction of the environment by many mining companies. After they have mined and taken the resources, they leave the environment unkempt for us. So, with this, I would want to add my voice, but humbly call upon all of us to keep an eagle eye on these companies to ensure that whatever they have written just does not become a paperwork, but it is actualised for our protection. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion numbered 10. Chairman of the Committee?

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Alhaji Dauda: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two Sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Mr Nanja: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion numbered 11. Chairman of the Committee?

Mining Lease Agreement between GoG and Abosso Goldfields Limited

Alhaji Dauda: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

In doing so, Mr Speaker, I wish to present the Committee's Report. And if you indulge me, I will skip the introduction and rather do the transitional arrangements and the conclusion. Mr Speaker, I urge that the *Hansard* captures the entire Report as having been read.

Introduction

On 18th July, 2025, the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah laid in Parliament the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Minister of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited in accordance with Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution and Section 5(4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703) as amended.

The First Deputy Speaker subsequently referred the Mining Lease to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report pursuant to Orders 240(2) and 145 of the Standing Orders of the House.

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister and Hon Deputy Minister of Lands and Natural Resources, Mr. Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah and Mr Yusif Sulemana respectively and other officials of the Ministry to consider the Mining Lease Agreement. A team from the Minerals Commission led by the Chief Executive Officer, Mr Martin Ayisi also attended the meeting to assist the Committee in its deliberations.

The Committee expresses its profound gratitude to the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, the Hon Deputy Minister and Officials of the Ministry and minerals Commission for their assistance during the deliberations.

Reference Document

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;
- iii. The Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703);

- iv. The Minerals and Mining (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 900);
- v. The Minerals and Mining Act (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Act 995);
- vi. Minerals and Mining (Compensation and Resettlement) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2175);
- vii. Minerals and Mining (Health, Safety and Technical) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2182);
- viii. Minerals and Mining (General) Regulations, 2012 (L.I. 2173); and
- ix. *Republic v High Court*, (General Jurisdiction 6), Accra; ex parte Attorney-General (Exton Cubic – Interested Party) [Unreported, Civil Motion No. J5/40/2018] dated 31st July, 2019.

Background Information

4.1 By an agreement dated 19th April, 1995 between the Government of the Republic of Ghana and Abosso Goldfields Limited, a mining lease was granted to the Company for a term of thirty (30) years. The lease covered an area of approximately 53.40 square kilometres situated in Damang, within the Wassa West District of the Western Region. The lease commenced on 19th April, 1995 and was due to expire on 18th April, 2025.

4.2 On 11th December, 2024, the Company applied to the Ministry through the Minerals Commission for the renewal of the Damang Mining Lease for a further period of thirty (30) years. However, by a Notice of Rejection dated 11th March, 2025, the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources, acting through the Minerals Commission, declined the application for renewal, citing reasons outlined in the said notice.

4.3 Following the rejection, differences arose between the Government and the Company regarding whether the Company had satisfied the conditions required for renewal of the lease. Pursuant to Clause 35 of the expired lease, which outlines dispute resolution procedures, the parties engaged in settlement discussions. As part of the agreed resolution, the Company waived its right to invoke any dispute under the expired lease. Consequently, and in accordance with Section 5(1) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703), the Government agreed to renew the Damang Mining Lease for a limited duration of twelve (12) months, effective 19th April, 2025 and ending 18th April, 2026. The renewal is subject to specific terms and conditions stipulated in the renewed lease.

4.4 Following the Executive and Cabinet's approval for the grant of the lease, the next essential step was to acquire a legal backing through ratification by Parliament in accordance with Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution.

Parties to the Mining Lease

The Parties to the Mining Lease are:

Government of the Republic of Ghana

The Mining Lease was executed by the Government of Ghana represented by the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural resources.

5.2 Abosso Goldfields Limited

Abosso Goldfields Limited is a company incorporated under the laws of Ghana and operates as a subsidiary of Gold Fields Limited, a multinational mining group headquartered in South Africa. Gold Fields is listed on both the Johannesburg Stock Exchange (JSE) and the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE). The Group manages nine (9) operational mines located across Australia, Canada, Chile, Ghana, South Africa, and Peru, in addition to one project in Canada. In Ghana, Gold Fields operates the Damang and Tarkwa Mines, both located in the Western Region.

The Lease Area

The Mining Lease covers an area of 52.39km² located at Damang in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Tenure of the Mining Lease

The tenure of the mining lease is twelve (12) months effective 19th April, 2025 and ending 18th April, 2026.

Justification

8.1 The ratification of the renewed Damang Mining Lease is a constitutional requirement pursuant to Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution, which requires parliamentary approval for the validity of mining agreements involving the exploitation of natural resources. The Damang Mine makes a substantial contribution to Ghana's gold production, with output exceeding 150,000 ounces in 2023 and 130,000 ounces in 2024, respectively.

8.2 Under the renewed lease, the Company shall continue to operate the mine in accordance with the applicable laws and regulations governing the mining sector. Gold Fields shall be entitled to all legal rights and obligations as stipulated under the lease and the laws of Ghana. Additionally, the Company is expected to recommence open-pit mining operations at the Damang Mine, including at the Juno, Nyame, and Amoanda satellite pits, within two (2) months of the execution of the lease agreement. This is subject to satisfactory completion of geotechnical assessments, acquisition of final permits, and the engagement of a local mining contractor.

8.3 Abosso Goldfields Limited currently provides direct employment to two hundred and seven (207) individuals and supports approximately one thousand, two hundred and ten (1,210) indirect jobs through contractors and auxiliary mine services. A failure to ratify the lease may result in the cessation of operations, which would

adversely affect the livelihoods of these employees and dependents.

8.4 Furthermore, the mine contributes significantly to Government revenue through the payment of royalties, taxes, and dividends. Beyond its statutory obligations, the Company, through the Gold Fields Ghana Foundation, has also implemented numerous social investment programmes aimed at improving the welfare and development of communities within the catchment area of the mine.

Observations

Estimated benefits of the mining lease

The Committee noted that while the request for ratification places no financial burden on the Government. The ratification would give the Company validity to mine and accrue to Government benefits with the potential to have a multiplier effect on Ghana's economy over the tenure of the Lease.

The Committee noted that the ratification of the mining lease would bring socio-economic benefits to the people of the mine area. The Lease provides for the payment of levies and funds such as the Community Development Fund that would be put into the development of the communities in the mine area. The lease also has the potential of creating about one thousand (1,000) direct mining jobs and several indirect jobs for the communities within the mine area.

Power of the Minerals Commission

The Committee noted that the Minerals Commission has the responsibility to ensure compliance to the provisions of the Mining Lease. The Commission has the power to undertake inspections at the Lease Area or the registered office of the Company.

The Commission is also empowered to effect penalties in the event that the company fails to comply with any provision of the Lease. Should the Company take actions that endanger the health and safety of persons or damage mining equipment and installations, the Commission has the power to issue penalties for which the Company is liable to pay.

The Minerals Commission also has the power to ensure that a sustainable life of mine plan that is capable of underpinning an investment decision by a third party is developed.

Transitional Arrangement

The Committee noted that the lease of Abooso Goldfields had expired. The Government, rejected their application for renewal due to non-fulfilment of prior commitments. Upon negotiations, government granted a one-year transitional lease (expiring in April 2026) to allow the company to undertake mine closure, cutbacks and site remediation in accordance with environmental standards.

The Committee observed that the lease shall not be subject to further extension,

transfer, mortgage or any other transaction. The Committee further noted that the lease shall revert to the State after its expiration in April 2026.

Conclusion

The Committee has critically examined the Mining Lease within the ambits of relevant Legislations on the subject. Even more significantly, the Mining Lease does not violate the letter and spirit of the Constitution. The Committee takes the considered view that the ratification of the Mining Lease would bring tremendous benefit to the Government and the socioeconomic development of communities in the mining area and also allow the Damang Mine close properly.

The Committee is also satisfied that the Company requesting for the Lease has the capacity to operate and maximise production to meet financial obligations stipulated in the Lease and recommends it for ratification.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this Report and ratify the Mining Lease granted to Abosso Goldfields Limited for its Damang Mine in accordance with article 268(1) of the 1992 Constitution and section 5(4) of the Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703) as amended.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Chairman of the Committee.

Motion moved; Report presented. Any seconder?

10.46 p.m.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion and in so doing, I will make a few remarks.

Mr Speaker, the Committee noted that the lease of Abosso Goldfields had expired. The Government rejected the application and upon negotiations, Government agreed to assign the Agreement for 12 months, and these 12 months is for a transitional period to enable them to do the necessary winding up processes which includes mining closure, cutbacks and site remediation in accordance with environmental standards.

It is noted that, after this, the Lease will not be further extended. This is for the preparation of the land and winding up practices. To avoid the teeming unemployed youth in the catchment area and other difficulties of immediate termination, one year has been granted. We, therefore, move that the House adopts the Report and then ratify the Agreement for 12 months.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Question proposed

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Suhuyini?

Alhaji Suhuyini Sayibu Alhassan: Mr Speaker, in supporting the Motion, I

just want to commend the Government of Ghana and for that matter, the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources for amicably resolving the impasse that initially arose between the Government of Ghana and this company.

Mr Speaker, Abosso Goldfields could not have been treated better, given the concession where a one-year lease was granted them to enable them among others, ensure that they work to pay the adequate severance packages of workers, do some reclamations and mine closures.

Mr Speaker, it is in line with the Government's empathy and sense of appreciation of the investments of investors and how to secure that. That is why I think that it is important that we commend Government for resolving this matter and for granting the concession of one-year lease to this company to enable it wrap up its operations nicely.

Mr Speaker, I just want to reiterate point 9.3 — the Transitional Arrangement which says that:

“As Members of the Committee, we noted that the lease of Abosso Goldfields had expired and the Government rejected their application for renewal due to non-fulfilment of prior commitments. Upon negotiations, Government granted a one-year transitional lease expiring in April 2026 to allow the company to undertake mine closure, cutbacks and site remediation in accordance with environmental standards.”

Mr Speaker, I would emphasise on the final paragraph:

“The Committee observed that the lease shall not be subject to further extension, transfer, mortgage or any other transaction. The Committee further noted that the lease shall revert to the State after its expiration on April 2026.”

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to reiterate this point that the Committee made in concluding that the House should ratify this lease for the Abosso Goldfields Company.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker, I thank you. I support and urge Members to ratify this Mining Lease for Goldfields. I think that what has been set here is that, it is now clear with the precedent with Goldfields that, it is not going to be automatic for mining companies after the end of their lease periods to expect automatic renewals and that, we will subject them to the commitments they make.

That is the message that we gave Goldfields. I am very happy that the Committee noted specifically that, at the end of the Lease, which is around April 2026, this Lease will not revert to them. It will revert to the state to decide the direction it will go. I believe that we should hold other mining companies

accountable for the commitments they make and that Lease renewals will not be automatic.

On that note, Mr Speaker, I urge Members to ratify it. I thank you.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order Paper *Addendum* 6.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, may I pray that we take the Motion numbered 1 on Order Paper *Addendum* 6, which is for the adoption of the Report of the Committee containing the consideration of 131 TUCs.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion numbered 1 on the Order Paper *Addendum* 6, is a Procedural Motion on the 131 TUCs.

Chairman of the Committee, you have the floor.

MOTION

Suspension of Order 104 (1)

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Lands

and Natural Resources on the Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and the following entities may be *moved* today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion numbered 1 on the Order Paper *Addendum* 6, accordingly moved.

Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee, Motion numbered 2 at page 16 of the Order Paper *Addendum* 6.

MOTIONS

Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Timber Utilisation Contract between GoG and 131 Companies

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, with respect, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Timber Utilisation contract between

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between GoG and 131 Companies*

the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and the following entities:

- i. Nasmo Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
- ii. Adjokyesant Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
- iii. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
- iv. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim Portion) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.
- v. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
- vi. Pyonteak Ventures Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

- vii. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
- viii. Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
- ix. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
- x. Supremo Woods Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
- xi. Fab Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Ajueso Forest Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region.
- xii. Diago Construction Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.
- xiii. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Subin Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

*Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the Timber Utilisation Contract
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| <p>xiv. Mr Bee Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>xxi. Ayipa Wood Company Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xv. Manukab Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>xxii. Anthony Bosompem Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>xvi. Fosu and Fosuaa Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>xxiii. R. K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Range Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xvii. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>xxiv. Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>xviii. Rakhishem Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>xxv. R. K. Preprah and Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> |
| <p>xix. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>xxvi. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> |
| <p>xx. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>xxvii. Ayum Forest Products limited in respect of the Bonkoni Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> |

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xxviii. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Bono Region.

xxix. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bia Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

xxx. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

xxxi. Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Anwia Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

xxxii. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

xxxiii. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

xxxiv. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Anhwiaso East Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region.

xxxv. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Awisam Seidukrom Off Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region.

xxxvi. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien Block II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

xxxvii. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

xxxviii. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Waiwso Forest District of the Western North Region.

xxxix. Samartex Timbers and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Nimri Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

xl. Gimpex Limited in respect of the Supuma Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

xli. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

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| <p>xlii. Broadwater Company Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve within the Mpraeso Forest District of the Easter Region.</p> | <p>xlix. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>xliii. Elton and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>1. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xliv. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>li. Gimpex Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xliv. R.K. Peprah Company Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> | <p>lii. Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>xlvi. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>liii. John Bitar and Company Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> |
| <p>xlvi. Kan Royal Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>liv. GWP Ghana Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xlvi. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>lv. Dangyimah and Sons Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |

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| <p>lvi. Goodrich Packaging Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>lxiii. Coppon Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Birim Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> |
| <p>lvii. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Santomang Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lxiv. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Totua Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>lviii. Slyvent Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lxv. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> |
| <p>lix. New Abrabo Construction Limited in respect of the Jema Asemkrom Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lxvi. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Bonsam Bepo Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> |
| <p>lx. Yusam Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>lxvii. S.K. Owusu Timbers Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> |
| <p>lxi. R.K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>lxviii. A.O. Mainoo Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamekyere Off-Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>lxii. Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lxix. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Processing Limited in respect of the Akwadaakrom Off-Reserve within the Dormaa</p> |

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Forest District of the Bono Region.

Enchi Forest District of the Western Region.

- lxx. Timber and Consultation Limited in respect of the Nsuensa Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.
- lxxi. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Mafia 'b' Off-Reserve within the Juabaso Forest District of the Western Region.
- lxxii. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bosomkese Forest Reserve within the Bechem Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
- lxxiii. Anglogold Ashanti (Ghana) Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
- lxxiv. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Bia North Tributaries Forest Reserve within the Juabeso Forest District of the Western Region.
- lxxv. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
- lxxvi. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bio Tano Forest Reserve within the

- lxxvii. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Ayum Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
- lxxviii. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Bowiye Range Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
- lxxix. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
- lxxx. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Mafia 'C' OFF-Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.
- lxxxii. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Suhum Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.
- lxxxiii. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK 1 Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region Region.
- lxxxiiii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Yoyo River Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

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| lxxxiv. | Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region. | | Forest District of the Central Region. |
| lxxxv. | Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region. | xc. | Adras Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. |
| lxxxvi. | Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Pra Birim North Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region. | xcii. | Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region. |
| lxxxvii. | Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bura River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region. | xciii. | Berekum Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. |
| lxxxviii. | JMO Timber and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Kokotintin Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region. | xciv. | Ayipah Wood Company Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region. |
| lxxxix. | Coppon Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Pra Birim South Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region. | xcv. | AB Saab Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. |
| xc. | Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Assin Donkorkrom Off Reserve within the Dunkwa | xcvi. | Adjiboat Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region. |
| | | xcvii. | Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest |

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| | Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region. | civ. | Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Asukese Forest Reserve within the Sunyani Forest District of the Bono Region. |
| xcviii. | MF-Timart Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region. | cv. | Yiogo Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region |
| xcix. | Joaddai Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. | cvi. | Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Nsereso Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. |
| c. | Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini North/Nhwini Nyele Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region. | cvii. | Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Aiyaolo Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region. |
| ci. | J.M.O. Timbers Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region. | cviii. | Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Ayamfori Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region. |
| cii. | Versatile Ghana Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region. | cix. | Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Dwira Bansa Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region |
| ciii. | Vesta Construction and Sawmill Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. | cx. | Asuo Bomosadu Timber and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Benkasa Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. |

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| <p>cxii. Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Mamangso Off Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> | <p>cxix. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> |
| <p>cxiii. J.M.O Timber Limited in respect of the Afia Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> | <p>cxx. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Diabaakrom Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> |
| <p>cxiv. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Company Limited in respect of the Ayinabrim Off Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> | <p>cxxi. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Wiawso Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>cxv. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>cxxii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Suhuma Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>cxvi. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'A' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region</p> | <p>cxxiii. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Nkrabea Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>cxvii. Ejura Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve.</p> | <p>cxxiv. J.M.O Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>cxviii. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Tonton Forest Reserve within the Asankragua Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>cxxv. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Mamiri Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> |
| <p>cxviii. Logs Court Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve.</p> | |

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cxxvi. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.

cxxvii. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Trans Bia Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

cxxviii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini Suraw Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

cxxix. G.K.L. Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

xxxx. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'B' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

xxxxi. Western Hardwood Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

10.56 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in so doing, I present the Report of the Committee and urge that the *Hansard* captures the entire Report as

having been read, as I read the recommendation and conclusion.

Introduction

On Monday, 21st July, 2025, the Hon Minister for Health, on behalf of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, presented to the House, 131 Timber Utilisation Contracts (TUCs) requesting parliamentary ratification pursuant to Article 268(1) of the Constitution, Section 9 of the Timber Resources Management Act, 1997 (Act 547), and Regulation 77(1) of the Timber Resource Management and Legality Licensing Regulations, 2017 (L.I. 2254).

The Timber Utilisation Contracts (TUCs) were subsequently referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report in accordance with Orders 97(5) and 240 of the Standing Orders.

The TUCs presented to the House are Timber Utilisation Contracts between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and the following companies:

1. Nasmo Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region;
2. Adjokyesant Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the

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Dormaa Forest District of the
Bono Region.

3. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
4. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim Portion) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.
5. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
6. Pyonteak Ventures Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
7. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
8. Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
9. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the

Tarkwa Forest District of the
Western Region.

10. Supremo Woods Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
11. Fab Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Ajueso Forest Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region.
12. Diago Construction Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.
13. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Subin Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
14. Mr Bee Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
15. Manukab Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
16. Fosu and Fosuaa Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

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17. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

18. Rakhishem Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

19. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

20. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

21. Ayipa Wood Company Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

22. Anthony Bosompem Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

23. R. K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Range Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

24. Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

25. R. K. Preprah and Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

26. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

27. Ayum Forest Products limited in respect of the Bonkoni Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

28. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Bono Region.

29. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bia Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

30. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

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31. Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Anwia Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

32. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

33. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

34. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Anhwiaso East Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region.

35. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Awisam Seidukrom Off Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region.

36. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien Block II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

37. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

38. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Waiwso Forest District of the Western North Region.

39. Samartex Timbers and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Nimri Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

40. Gimpex Limited in respect of the Supuma Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

41. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

42. Broadwater Company Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve within the Mpraeso Forest District of the Easter Region.

43. Elton and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.

44. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.

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45. R.K. Peprah Company Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

46. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.

47. Kan Royal Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

48. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

49. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

50. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

51. Gimpex Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie

Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

52. Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

53. John Bitar and Company Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

54. GWP Ghana Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

55. Dangyimah and Sons Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawei Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

56. Goodrich Packaging Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

57. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Santomang Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.

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58. Slyvent Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

59. New Abrabo Construction Limited in respect of the Jema Asemkrom Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

60. Yusam Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

61. R.K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

62. Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

63. Coppon Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Birim Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.

64. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Totua Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa

Forest District of the Western North Region.

65. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

66. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Bonsam Bepo Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

67. S.K. Owusu Timbers Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.

68. A.O. Mainoo Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamekyere Off-Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

69. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Processing Limited in respect of the Akwadaakrom Off-Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

70. Timber and Consultation Limited in respect of the Nsuensa Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.

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71. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Mafia 'b' Off-Reserve within the Juabaso Forest District of the Western Region.

72. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bosomkese Forest Reserve within the Bechem Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

73. Anglogold Ashanti (Ghana) Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

74. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Bia North Tributaries Forest Reserve within the Juabeso Forest District of the Western Region.

75. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

76. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bio Tano Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western Region.

77. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Ayum Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

78. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Bowiye Range Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

79. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

80. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Mafia 'C' OFF-Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.

81. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Suhum Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.

82. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK 1 Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

83. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Yoyo River Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

84. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region.

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85. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

86. Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Pra Birim North Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.

87. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bura River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

88. JMO Timber and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Kokotintin Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

89. Coppon Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Pra Birim South Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.

90. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Assin Donkorkrom Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

91. Adras Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

92. Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

93. Berekum Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

94. Ayipah Wood Company Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

95. AB Saab Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

96. Adjiboat Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

97. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

98. MF-Timart Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

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99. Joaddai Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

100. Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini North/Nhwini Nyele Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

101. J.M.O. Timbers Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

102. Versatile Ghana Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

103. Vesta Construction and Sawmill Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

104. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Asukese Forest Reserve within the Sunyani Forest District of the Bono Region.

105. Yiogo Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest

Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

106. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Nsereso Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

107. Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Aiyalo Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.

108. Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Ayamfori Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

109. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Dwira Bansa Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

110. Asuo Bomosadu Timber and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Benkasa Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

111. Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Mamangso Off Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.

112. J.M. O Timber Limited in respect of the Afia Shelterbelt

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Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

113. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Company Limited in respect of the Ayinabrim Off Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

114. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

115. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'A' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

116. Ejura Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve.

117. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Tonton Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

118. Logs Court Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve.

119. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa

Forest District of the Western Region.

120. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Diabaakrom Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

121. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Wiawso Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

122. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Suhuma Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.

123. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Nkrabea Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

124. J.M. O Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

125. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Mamiri Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

126. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure

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River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.

127. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Trans Bia Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

128. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini Suraw Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

129. G.K.L. Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

130. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'B' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

131. Western Hardwood Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

Deliberations

The Committee, in its deliberations, met with the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah Kofi-Buah, the Hon Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural

Resources, Mr Yusif Sulemana, the Acting Chief Director of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Innocent Haligah, the Chief Executive of the Forestry Commission, Dr Hugh C. A. Brown, and other senior officers of the Ministry and the Forestry Commission.

The Committee is grateful to the stakeholders and experts consulted for their valuable inputs.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following relevant documents during its deliberations:

The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

- a. The Standing Orders of Parliament;
- b. The Timber Resource Management Act, 1997 (Act 547);
- c. The Timber Resource Management (Amendment) Act, 2002 (Act 617);
- d. The Timber Resource Management Regulations, 1998 (L.I. 1649);
- e. The Timber Resource Management (Amendment) Regulations, 2003 (L.I. 1721); and
- f. The Timber Resource Management and Legality Licensing Regulations, 2017 (L.I. 2254).

Background Information

Subsequent to the passage of the Timber Resources Management Act, 1997 (Act 547), it became a legal requirement that all timber concessions and leases issued prior to the coming into force of Act 547 be converted into Timber Utilisation Contract (TUCs) and presented to Parliament for ratification.

Subsequently, the coming into force of the Timber Resource Management and Legality Licensing Regulations, 2017 (L.I. 2254) further reinforced the legal requirement. It became mandatory for a timber contractor holding a lease, contract, license, or any rights other than a TUC or any other legally recognised instrument to, within six months after coming into force of L.I. 2254, apply to the Forestry Commission for a conversion of the lease, contract, licence or permit into a Timber Utilisation Contract.

Cumulatively, the provisions of the Timber Resources Management Act, 1997 (Act 547) and the Timber Resource Management and Legality Licensing Regulations, 2017 (L.I. 2254) are to harmonise the allocation of timber rights under a standardised legal regime for transparency, accountability, and sustainable forest resource management. It is also to ensure compliance with national forest governance policies and international legality verification standards.

Pursuant to the legal imperatives, the Ministry of Lands and Natural

Resources, in collaboration with the Forestry Commission undertook a comprehensive review and regularisation process, which involved validating and converting applicable extant leases into Timber Utilisation Contracts and where possible, to issue new timber utilisation contracts.

The review process, pursuant to the legal requirements, resulted in a total of 132 TUCs having been signed with various companies. The 132 TUCs comprise 63 converted extant leases and 69 newly issued TUCs for presentation to Parliament for ratification. Appendices A and B respectively show the 63 extant leases converted into TUCs and the 69 newly issued TUCs.

Observations

Non-enforcement of compliance

From the outset, the Committee wishes to point out that these leases should have been presented to Parliament for consideration immediately after coming into force of the Timber Resource Management and Legality Licensing Regulations, 2017 (L.I. 2254) in 2017 in compliance with Regulation 77(1) of the L.I.

In the circumstances, urgent action needs to be taken to ratify these leases to ensure compliance with the domestic legislative regime as well as international legality verification standards, particularly the Forest Law Enforcement, Governance and Trade (FLEGT) provisions under the Voluntary

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Partnership Agreement (VPA) with the European Union.

Ghana, being a party to the Voluntary Partnership Agreement (VPA) with the European Union, is under obligation to export only legally sourced timber to the European market. The conversion and ratification of these TUCs are a key milestone in operationalising the VPA and securing the issuance of Forest Law Enforcement, Governance and Trade (FLEGT) licenses by 3rd August 2025. Achieving this objective will position Ghana as a legal timber trade country and protect its access to high-value export markets.

Justification for the ratifying these timber concessions is also anchored on Ghana's international obligation under the Forest Law Enforcement, Governance and Trade (FLEGT) initiative, which set deadlines for the cessation of export of illegal timber. The original deadline was set for June, but was extended following engagements with European stakeholders. Failure to ratify the Timber Utilisation Contracts (TUCs) before the deadline of 3rd August 2025 would render Ghanaian timber exports non-compliant with FLEGT requirements, effectively barring access to critical European markets. Further delay in the ratification of these TUCs poses a serious risk not only to the country's timber export industry but also to the broader economy, as it would negatively affect numerous businesses along the value chain. With Parliament potentially going on recess ahead of the deadline, urgent

ratification is imperative to safeguard Ghana's timber sector and honour its international commitments.

Regulatory reform and transparency

The conversion process has presented an opportunity to overhaul and streamline the timber rights allocation regime. It has enabled the identification of and regularisation of legacy concessions that were previously operating outside the framework of Act 547 and L.I. 2254. This reform enhances transparency, strengthens legality verification systems, and provides a clear and uniform basis for enforcing compliance across the timber sector.

Mitigation of illegal timber trade

By bringing all outstanding leases into the formalised TUC framework, the process closes loopholes that have historically enabled the harvesting and trade of timber without proper oversight. Closing the loopholes directly contributes to the reduction of illegal logging and improves the traceability of timber from source to market both domestically and internationally.

Revenue mobilisation and economic gains

The formalisation of these extant timber rights ensures the payment of appropriate Timber Rights Fees (TRFs) and other statutory charges. It also improves revenue collection mechanisms within the forestry sector and contributes to the fiscal

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sustainability of forest management operations. Increased legal timber operations will further stimulate local economic activity, particularly in the timber processing and export value chains.

Challenges requiring remedial action

Farmer consent and off-reserve conflicts

In off-reserve areas, logging operations have often proceeded without prior consent from local farmers, resulting in the destruction of crops and strained relations. Although the law requires written authorisation from landowners before timber rights are granted, it was revealed that consent is usually sought after the contract is issued—an approach contrary to the Timber Resources Management Act. This practice was acknowledged as a deviation that must be corrected.

Weak Enforcement of Environmental and Reforestation Provisions

- (i) Concerns were raised regarding the lack of adherence to environmental and reforestation obligations stipulated in TUC agreements. While harvesting plans and logging manuals exist, reforestation commitments are either absent from the contracts or treated as the sole responsibility of government

agencies using management fees. This approach was deemed insufficient and contrary to legal provisions, which mandate that timber companies undertake reforestation during the contract period.

- (ii) The Committee emphasised the need to align timber exploitation with sustainable forest management, insisting that companies granted rights to harvest timber must also commit to afforestation. It expressed concern that many of the contracts lacked explicit reforestation provisions, which contradicts the Timber Resources Management Act.

The Committee rejected the Forestry Commission's justification that reforestation obligations are covered by management fees paid by timber firms, stressing that this does not absolve companies of their legal duty to plant trees.

It reiterated that the principle of “if you cut, you must plant” must not be compromised, as sustainable forestry is essential for environmental protection and the long-term viability of the timber industry. The Committee therefore called on the Ministry and the Forestry Commission to ensure future contracts fully reflect these legal requirements and that all stakeholders comply accordingly.

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Limited Implementation of Social Responsibility Agreements (SRAs)

Although Social Responsibility Agreements (SRAs) are a legal requirement, many of the contracts reviewed lacked clear provisions detailing the social commitments of timber firms to host communities. While some companies have reportedly provided infrastructure such as roads, schools and palaces, no official list or verification was available at the time as proof to the Committee. Members requested a detailed inventory of these projects to ensure that companies are fulfilling their social obligations.

Inspection of concession areas

In view of the challenges discussed in paragraph 5.5 of this report, the Committee is purposed on undertaking regular inspection visits to the contract areas to ensure that the right holders are within their assigned limits and undertaking their activities pursuant to terms of their contract and not engaging in activities that adversely affect members of the community.

Recommendations and Conclusion

The Committee, by consensus recommends that the House adopts its report and pursuant to Article 268(1) of the 1992 Constitution, ratify the 131 Timber Utilisation Contracts presented to Parliament, considering the issues outlined earlier and also that the companies applied in time, but the delay

has been occasioned by administrative lapses.

Respectfully Submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion is moved and the Report has been presented. Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion. In so doing, I will make a few comments.

Mr Speaker, we have gone through all the processes and we actually have a plan of reforestation. We presented it and, more importantly, ratifying this is for both legal and economic reasons. In that, if we fail to ratify these TUCs by 3rd August this year, we cannot export our timber to the European markets.

So, having studied their documents and met the standards, the contracts were divided into two. Some were to be converted and others were new and we agreed to approve all of them. Looking at the economic and the legal implications, we, therefore, call on the House to support the Motion and adopt it, so we can ratify the Timber Utilisation Contracts of the 131 companies.

Question proposed.

Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I rise to support the Committee's Report and make few comments.

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Mr Speaker, I am very happy that the Hon Minister is here, so that I will bring this to his attention. Mr Speaker, when we met at the Committee level, I raised about three issues with the officers who appeared before the Committee. The first one has to do with their financial muscles.

If we look through the agreement, we need to find out if those applying for the TUC are in a better position to do whatever they are seeking to do. The answer provided suggests that all of them are in a better position to undertake those operations.

But Mr Speaker, some of them will also sign the agreement and leave the compartment for years without working in those compartments. And in the local communities, we have illegal chainsaw operators.

They will also enter the forest or the compartment and start cutting down the trees. So, we always see a clash between the contractors and the local people and they will bring in the police and military to harass the local people over there. The answer they provided is that some of the contracts have commencement dates. So, for example, if the agreement is signed today, they have two or five years to commence operations.

Mr Speaker, so the Hon Minister should let his officers go to the communities and educate them that the compartments they see are not an idle compartment. It belongs to an individual,

but operations will start, maybe, two- or three-years' time.

So, that people will get to understand that this is not a freehold or the compartment is not lying idle to avoid this kind of clash that we witness. Because at the end of the day, it comes back to us, the opinion leaders.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, in conclusion, the Minister should try to let his officers help us educate the community people, so that they will not be clashing with the security agencies to avoid unforeseen attacks on individuals.

Mr Speaker, with these few remarks, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker, I urge Hon Members to support the ratification of these TUCs. Mr Speaker, by approval of the TUCs, Ghana will have made significant progress in the legal trade of timber.

In fact, we will become the first African country to meet the requirement of the EU to trade in legal timber, next to Indonesia. This is a very transformational period and it will help in addressing the sustainability challenges that we have to meet the Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 1.

So, I urge Members to really approve these TUCs.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

11.06 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, we will take the Order Paper *Addendum 7*. We are now coming to the consequential Resolutions, having adopted the Motions.

Hon Members, we will take the Resolution numbered 1 on Order Paper *Addendum 7*.

RESOLUTIONS

Mining Lease Agreement between GoG and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS

1. By the provisions of Article 268(1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the

Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;

2. In pursuance of the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem West (16.59 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem West (16.59 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Resolution numbered 2 at page 2 of Order Paper *Addendum 7*.

Yes, Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

**Mining Lease Agreement between
GoG and Newmont Golden Ridge
Limited**

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker. I beg to move:

WHEREAS

1. By the provisions of Article 268 (1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;
2. In pursuance of the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana (GoG) has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem East (47.67 km²) in Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Now therefore, this House, in accordance with the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem East (47.67 km²) in Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Resolution numbered 2 at page 2 of the Order Paper *Addendum 7* has been moved. Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion ably moved by the Minister.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Resolution numbered 3 at page 3 of the Order Paper *Addendum 7*.

Yes, Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

**Mining Lease Agreement between
GoG and Gateway Exploration
Limited for the Mining of Gold at
Obobetwao**

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS

1. By the provisions of Article 268(1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;

In pursuance of the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Resolution has been moved; any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we now move to the Resolution numbered 4 at pages 3 and 4 of the Order Paper *Addendum* 7.

Yes, Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

Mining Lease Agreement between GoG and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the Mining of Gold and other Minerals at Ntotroso

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker. I beg to move:

WHEREAS

By the provisions of Article 268(1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of

Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;

In pursuance of the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Resolution numbered 5 at pages 4 and 5 of the Order Paper *Addendum 7*.

Yes, Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

Mining Lease Agreement between GoG and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the Mining of Gold at Damang.

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker. I beg *move*:

WHEREAS

1. By the provisions of Article 268(1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;

2. In pursuance of the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the

mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abooso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any seconder?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Resolution numbered 6?

Yes, Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

Timber Utilisation Contract between GoG and 129 Entities.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

WHEREAS

1. By the provisions of Article 268(1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;
2. In pursuance of the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) in respect of the under-listed entities:

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268(1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources) and the following entities:

- i. Nasmo Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region;

Timber Utilisation Contract between the GoG and 129 Entities

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ii. Adjokyesant Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. iii. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region. iv. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim Portion) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region. v. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region. vi. Pyonteak Ventures Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region. vii. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Bia Tano viii. Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region. ix. Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region. x. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region. xi. Supremo Woods Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region. xii. Fab Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Ajueso Forest Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region. xiii. Diago Construction Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region. xiv. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Subin Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region. xv. Mr Bee Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region. xvi. Manukab Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region. |
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Timber Utilisation Contract between the GoG and 129 Entities

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| <p>xvii. Fosu and Fosuaa Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>xxiv. R. K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Range Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xviii. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>xxv. Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>xix. Rakhishem Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>xxvi. R. K. Preprah and Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> |
| <p>xx. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>xxvii. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> |
| <p>xxi. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>xxviii. Ayum Forest Products limited in respect of the Bonkoni Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> |
| <p>xxii. Ayipa Wood Company Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> | <p>xxix. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> |
| <p>xxiii. Anthony Bosompem Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>xxx. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bia Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> |
| | <p>xxxi. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve</p> |

Timber Utilisation Contract between the GoG and 129 Entities

within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

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| xxxii. Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Anwia Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region. | xxxix. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Waiwso Forest District of the Western North Region. |
| xxxiii. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region. | xl. Samartex Timbers and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Nimri Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region. |
| xxxiv. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region. | xli. Gimpex Limited in respect of the Supuma Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region. |
| xxxv. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Anhwiaso East Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region. | xlii. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Central Region. |
| xxxvi. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Awisam Seidukrom Off Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region. | xliii. Broadwater Company Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve within the Mpraeso Forest District of the Easter Region. |
| xxxvii. Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien Block II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region. | xliv. Elton and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region. |
| xxxviii. Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai | xlv. Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region. |

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| <p>xlvi. R.K. Peprah Company Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> | <p>North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>xlvii. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>liv. John Bitar and Company Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> |
| <p>xlvi. Kan Royal Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>lv. GWP Ghana Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>xlix. Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>lvi. Dangyimah and Sons Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawei Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>1. Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lvii. Goodrich Packaging Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> |
| <p>li. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> | <p>lviii. Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Santomang Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>lii. Gimpex Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> | <p>lix. Slyvent Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
| <p>liii. Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries</p> | <p>lx. New Abrabo Construction Limited in respect of the Jema Asemkrom Forest Reserve</p> |

Timber Utilisation Contract between the GoG and 129 Entities

within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

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| <p>lxi. Yusam Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>lxvii. S.K. Owusu Timbers Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> |
| <p>lxii. R.K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> | <p>lxviii. A.O. Mainoo Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamekyere Off-Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> |
| <p>lxii. Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lxix. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Processing Limited in respect of the Akwadaakrom Off-Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> |
| <p>lxiii. Coppon Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Birim Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> | <p>lxx. Timber and Consultation Limited in respect of the Nsuensa Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> |
| <p>lxiv. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Totua Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>lxxi. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Mafia 'b' Off-Reserve within the Juabaso Forest District of the Western Region.</p> |
| <p>lxv. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> | <p>lxxii. Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bosomkese Forest Reserve within the Bechem Forest District of the Ahafo Region.</p> |
| <p>lxvi. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Bonsam Bepo Forest Reserve within the Goaso</p> | <p>lxxiii. Anglogold Ashanti (Ghana) Limited in respect of the Oda</p> |

Timber Utilisation Contract between the GoG and 129 Entities

	River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.	lxxxix.	John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Suhum Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.
lxxiv.	Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Bia North Tributaries Forest Reserve within the Juabeso Forest District of the Western Region.	lxxxii.	Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK 1 Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.
lxxv.	Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.	lxxxiii.	Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Yoyo River Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.
lxxvi.	Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bio Tano Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western Region.	lxxxiv.	Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region.
lxxvii.	Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Ayum Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.	lxxxv.	Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.
lxxviii.	Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Bowiye Range Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.	lxxxvi.	Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Pra Birim North Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.
lxxix.	Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.	lxxxvii.	Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bura River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.
lxxx.	John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Mafia 'C' OFF-Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.		

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lxxxviii. JMO Timber and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Kokotintin Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

lxxxix. Coppon Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Pra Birim South Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.

xc. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Assin Donkorkrom Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

xc. Adras Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

xcii. Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

xciii. Berekum Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

xciv. Ayipah Wood Company Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

xcv. AB Saab Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

xcvi. Adjiboat Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

xcvii. Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

xcviii. MF-Timart Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

xcix. Joaddai Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

c. Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini North/Nhwini Nyele Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

ci. J.M.O. Timbers Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

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| <p>cii. Versatile Ghana Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> <p>ciii. Vesta Construction and Sawmill Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> <p>ciii. Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Asukese Forest Reserve within the Sunyani Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> <p>civ. Yiogo Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> <p>cv. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Nsereso Off Reverse within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> <p>cvi. Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Aiyalo Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> <p>cvii. Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Ayamfori Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.</p> | <p>cviii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Dwira Bansa Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cix. Asuo Bomosadu Timber and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Benkasa Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> <p>cx. Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Mamangso Off Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.</p> <p>cxi. J.M.O Timber Limited in respect of the Afia Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> <p>cxiii. Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Company Limited in respect of the Ayinabrim Off Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> <p>cxii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cxiii. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'A' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> |
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Timber Utilisation Contract between the GoG and 129 Entities

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| <p>cxiv. Ejura Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve.</p> <p>cxv. Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Tonton Forest Reserve within the Asankragua Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cxvi. Logs Court Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve.</p> <p>cxvii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cxviii. Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Diabaakrom Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.</p> <p>cxix. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Wiawso Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> <p>cxx. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Suhuma Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> | <p>cxxi. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Nkrabea Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> <p>cxxii. J.M.O Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.</p> <p>cxxiii. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Mamiri Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cxxiv. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cxxv. cxxvii. Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Trans Bia Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.</p> <p>cxxvi. Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini Suraw Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.</p> <p>cxxvii. G.K.L. Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Bona Ben Forest Reserve within the</p> |
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Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

cxxviii. John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'B' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

cxxix. Western Hardwood Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Sanja Nanja): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question moved and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

11.16 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I would like to thank you very much for labouring with us to have all these mining agreements and timber licences approved by this House.

So, Mr Speaker, these mining agreements were entered into by our predecessors, but they could not or indeed, refused or neglected to have those agreements approved by this

House. The NDC promised that if we came into office, we would have all these agreements approved, so that the mining companies can operate within a proper legal framework, based on a sound agreement that gives them certainty and comfort to fulfil their part of the bargain.

So, today we have approved all those agreements. We have approved 131 TUCs, and I believe that the companies will now operate in comfort, in confidence and lawfully. So let me thank you, Mr Speaker, for ensuring that this happened. Let me thank our Clerks; it is getting to midnight and they are still here with us, working very diligently and efficiently and making sure that we comply with all our procedures and rules. So, we thank the Clerks.

Let me thank Colleagues. I can see the Chamber is full; that Side is empty. Let me thank the Backbenchers. Let me thank our friends in the media for keeping us company and making sure that whatever happens here is reported to the rest of the country. But I know that the whole nation is watching. We are now live on television, so everybody is watching us. This is how far sometimes we go in order to fulfil our responsibilities as Members of Parliament.

We also thank the security personnel and our Audio-visual Department for staying with us up to this time to cover proceedings and project it to the rest of the country. Even though our Friends are not here, we know they are watching us. So, I want to thank them for watching us

from their offices and their homes and to assure them that, we in the NDC will use our two-thirds majority effectively to the benefit of Ghanaians. [*Hear! Hear!*]

We have four other Independent Members who have joined us, so we do not run short of numbers. Indeed, in this Parliament, I have said consistently that we can run a three-shift Parliament. We can run a 24-hour Parliament where I will divide the numbers into three, and then at every shift, I can have a quorum. [*Hear! Hear!*]

So, Mr Speaker, I thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you and I also thank Hon Members for their endurance. We have sat in excess of five hours. With due reference to

Standing Order 56(2), I will proceed to adjourn the House.

The House is adjourned till Friday, 25th July, 2025 at—

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, midday. Please, Mr Speaker, tomorrow is Friday. We need to start Business early so Members can—And we have a Colleague whose husband's funeral will be held in the precinct of Parliament.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the House is accordingly adjourned till Friday, 25th July, 2025, at 12 noon.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 11.24 p.m. till Friday, 25th July, 2025, at 12 noon.

